
2026 Best Ball Full-Season Team Analysis

32-Team Draft Guide · Ceiling Tiers · Full-Season Outlook & Stacks

ADP Snapshot Date: 2026-07-02 | Underdog Best Ball Mania VII

Methodology

This guide is model-grounded, built on per-team ceiling-season probability scores (0–100 relative scale) derived from offensive-environment quality, win-total projections, pace, pass-rate, QB trajectory, scheme changes, and shootout-script likelihood. All analysis is framed for the full Underdog Best Ball Mania VII structure: Weeks 1–14 accumulate to ADVANCE (top-2 of 12 teams); Weeks 15–17 are single-elimination rounds to WIN the championship. Ceiling tiers (ELITE / HIGH / MID / LOW) represent ceiling-season *upside* probability — the likelihood a team's offense dramatically overperforms its projection — not expected value. ADP figures are Underdog ADP sourced via ffdataroma export. Adjusted ranks reflect model nudges (capped ± 8 ADP spots) layered on market price. Stack scores are correlation-weighted combination values from the repo's stack-menu model. All figures are forward-looking 2026 signals.

ELITE	Top 6 teams — premier ceiling environments; concentrate & stack.
HIGH	Next 8 — strong environments; selective concentration.
MID	Middle 12 — mixed; mine individuals or cheap stacks.
LOW	Bottom 6 — fade the team; roster studs on their own merits.

Ceiling-Tier Legend & Table of Contents

Teams listed alphabetically by city name. Tier colours: **ELITE** (deep green) · **HIGH** (teal) · **MID** (slate) · **LOW** (coral).
Score = ceiling-season probability (0–100 relative scale). Rank = ceiling rank out of 32 teams.

8	Arizona Cardinals (ARI)	HIGH	73.7
27	Atlanta Falcons (ATL)	LOW	28.0
11	Baltimore Ravens (BAL)	HIGH	67.7
19	Buffalo Bills (BUF)	MID	54.9
32	Carolina Panthers (CAR)	LOW	13.8
6	Chicago Bears (CHI)	ELITE	77.5
2	Cincinnati Bengals (CIN)	ELITE	84.1
23	Cleveland Browns (CLE)	MID	46.2
3	Dallas Cowboys (DAL)	ELITE	82.7
17	Denver Broncos (DEN)	MID	60.0
1	Detroit Lions (DET)	ELITE	84.5
15	Green Bay Packers (GB)	MID	63.4
22	Houston Texans (HOU)	MID	46.9
25	Indianapolis Colts (IND)	MID	32.4
21	Jacksonville Jaguars (JAX)	MID	50.3
4	Kansas City Chiefs (KC)	ELITE	82.6
26	Las Vegas Raiders (LV)	MID	30.7
9	Los Angeles Chargers (LAC)	HIGH	70.5
7	Los Angeles Rams (LAR)	HIGH	76.6
30	Miami Dolphins (MIA)	LOW	23.9
29	Minnesota Vikings (MIN)	LOW	24.4
10	New England Patriots (NE)	HIGH	70.0
24	New Orleans Saints (NO)	MID	45.8
14	New York Giants (NYG)	HIGH	63.5
31	New York Jets (NYJ)	LOW	22.8
12	Philadelphia Eagles (PHI)	HIGH	66.8
20	Pittsburgh Steelers (PIT)	MID	54.2
13	San Francisco 49ers (SF)	HIGH	66.8
16	Seattle Seahawks (SEA)	MID	62.1
5	Tampa Bay Buccaneers (TB)	ELITE	79.0

18	Tennessee Titans (TEN)	MID	56.2
28	Washington Commanders (WAS)	LOW	24.9

Arizona Cardinals (ARI)

Ceiling Score **73.7** | Rank **8/32** | Tier **HIGH**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **HIGH** — **score 73.7, rank 8/32**. A pass-leaning, high-total offense (env 76) whose own porous coverage (1st-percentile) manufactures shootouts — a genuine ceiling environment despite a 4.5 win total. Concentrate on the cheap pieces (McBride, MHJ, Michael Wilson) and pair with the late QB; this is a stack-at-value team, not a fade.

Full-Season Environment

Average pace (58th pctl, 62.3 plays/g), a **top-8 pass rate of 58.9%**, new OC Nathaniel Hackett (team_ceiling tags the playcaller as a new HC staff post-Gannon) — a scheme upgrade the model prices in. The ceiling drivers are **Env quality (weight 0.249), Pass rate (0.160), Scheme upgrade (0.093), Pace (0.085)** with a shootout-script kicker (0.071). The engine of the whole thing is the defense: **soft coverage (1.6 pctl), soft run D (10.9 pctl), elite pass rush (92 pctl)**. That produces a RUN funnel and a TE funnel, but the more important best-ball fact is that a 1st-percentile secondary keeps the Cardinals' own games high-total — the "weak own pass-D → shootout volume" fade flag is a *feature* here. The offense trails often (4.5 wins), which means pass volume with the game in front of them.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

McBride's best regular-season spot is **W4 @ NYG**; his scheme-fit zone weeks land **W6 & W10 vs LAR (heavy zone 79%)** against his 95th-pctl zone strength. Advance-phase target volume is stable (McBride 155 targets, 100th-pctl advancement). The playoff run: **W15 @ NYJ, W16 vs NO, W17 ARI @ LV (game env 52.2, LV opp ceiling 30.7)**. That W17 is a middling shootout — playable but the softest of the elite-tier finales. McBride's playoff-week upside ticks *up* into the final (w15/16/17 up 0.7/0.7/0.8), so this is a build that gets better, not worse, as you approach the championship.

Key Fantasy Players

Trey McBride (TE) — ADP 24.2, adj_rank 22 (pos #2), model +1. 15.0 pg / 35.9 ceiling, **99th projection, 99th advancement, 99th SIS value**. Elite volume (112 rec / 155 targets), 58% slot, 53% motion, red-zone hog (**1.6 inside-20/g, 27 end-zone**). Coverage read: **zone-beater (2.263 vs 1.483 YPRR zone/man, both seasons)** — cash him vs LAR twice. The one caution is the trend (YPRR 2.14→1.78) and a 3rd-pctl spike-week, so he's a floor-anchoring positional cheat code more than a tournament-week detonator.

Marvin Harrison Jr. (WR) — ADP 67.8 (pos #~19 at R6). 11.4 pg / 30.1 ceiling, **79th projection, 88th boom**. Boundary X, 75% wide. Levers: **wins separation vs man (2yr)** and contested-catch equity → cash vs press/man; best spots **W4 @ NYG and W5 @ DET (heavy man)**. RZ: 0.8 i20/g, 31 end-zone.

Michael Wilson (WR) — ADP 83.4, adj_rank 83 (fair). 9.8 pg / 25.6 ceiling, 68th projection, motion weapon (**1.65 vs 1.22 YPRR in/out of motion**, 54% motion), also a man-separation winner. Flagged FLOOR RISK (low weekly floor) — a correlation piece, not a standalone.

Jeremiah Love (RB, rookie) — ADP 27.3, adj_rank 28 (pos #13). 16.5 pg / **36.8 ceiling**, 92nd projection/advancement, three-down workhorse (255 carry / 86 targets), Notre Dame ceiling pctl 97.3. Pass-catching-back lever fits the new scheme (light boxes, checkdowns). Not a stack piece but a strong standalone RB anchor from this offense.

Late QBs: Jacoby Brissett (ADP 167.8) is the stack driver — 12.5 pg, but a **man-struggler (5.63 Y/A vs man)**; Carson Beck (rookie, ADP 228, 30.3 ceiling, 91.0 college ceiling pctl) is the dart with more juice.

Stacks & Correlation

Best menu stack is **heavy: Brissett (R14) + McBride (R3) + MHJ (R6) + Wilson (R7)**, stack_score 0.747, value_ct 3, latest round 14 — a fully late-QB build (qb_late True). Standard **Brissett + McBride + MHJ** (0.730) is the sweet spot. W17 **ARI @ LV** bring-backs: **Brock Bowers (ADP 20)**, **Jalen Nailor (152.7)**, **Tre Tucker (159.8)** — Bowers is the clean high-end bring-back to pair with a McBride final. Because the QB is free, you can build the entire pass-catcher tree at or below market and still spend early capital elsewhere (Love at 27, McBride at 24). Correlation works all season: soft own coverage → the Cardinals' games stay high-total in the advance phase, not just W17.

Draft Takeaway

A concentrate-and-stack team where the value is structural: elite positional anchors (McBride pos #2, Love pos #13) plus mid-round WRs *and* a punt QB that all correlate. Go-to build: McBride or Love early, add MHJ (R6) and Wilson (R7), close with Brissett (R14) and a Bowers bring-back. The trap is over-drafting Brissett's ceiling — treat him as the free glue on a shootout tree.

Atlanta Falcons (ATL)

Ceiling Score **28.0** | Rank **27/32** | Tier **LOW**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **LOW** — **score 28.0, rank 27/32**. An up-tempo, pass-leaning shell around a **low-total (env 36)** offense with unresolved QB play — volume without a scoring environment. Fade the ceiling-team concept; draft the individual studs (Bijan, London, Pitts) on their own merits and let someone else pay up for the Tua stack.

Full-Season Environment

Fast pace (68th pctl, 63.0 plays/g), 55.4% pass (10th-ranked), new OC Tommy Rees. The ceiling drivers are thin and top out at **Pass rate 0.115, Pace 0.102, Env quality 0.082, Conc. tree 0.080** — the limiters are explicit: "**QB uncertainty (caps ceiling)**" and a **low-total environment (6.5 wins, env 36)** where the model warns of "volume without efficiency — empty passing stats." Defense is **strong coverage (79.7 pctl), light pass rush (4.7 pctl)** — a RUN funnel and a **TE fortress (avoid TEs)**, which means opponents are funneled to the ground and the Falcons' own games skew lower-total. This is the anti-shootout profile.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

The saving grace is a genuinely **soft slate** — London, Bijan and Pitts all sit at **96th–99th-pctl matchup**. Bijan's best week is **W1 @ PIT**; London's scheme weeks are **W2 @ CAR** and **W3 @ GB (heavy zone 80/79%)** vs his 97th-pctl zone strength. Playoffs: **W15 vs WAS, W16 vs TB, W17 ATL @ NO (game env 36.9, NO opp ceiling 45.8)** — a *low-total* championship game, the weakest W17 environment among these eight teams. Bijan and London's playoff upside is elite anyway (w15/16/17 up 0.8/0.9/1.0), but that's talent overriding a poor game script.

Key Fantasy Players

Bijan Robinson (RB) — ADP 2.1, adj_rank 2 (pos #2). 20.6 pg / 46.0 ceiling, 98th projection, 100th ceiling, 73rd boom. Workhorse (286 carry / 99 targets), 98th YAC, 91st explosive, elusiveness surged (72.1→120.8). Zone lean + light-box receiving lever. The rare LOW-team player you draft at cost — a top-2 overall pick whose floor/ceiling are team-proof.

Drake London (WR) — ADP 17.4, adj_rank 16 (pos #7), model +1. 15.9 pg / 38.5 ceiling, 95th projection, 96th ceiling-pctl. 102 rec / 159 targets, RZ hog (1.3 i20/g, 23 end-zone). Scheme-fit **Cover 4 (98), Cover 3 (89)**; contested-catch and boundary-X levers. Coverage-agnostic per his boom profile despite a soft 33rd separation. An alpha earning target volume regardless of who throws it.

Kyle Pitts Sr. (TE) — ADP 90.6 (pos #~9 at R8). 10.8 pg / 28.2 ceiling, 89th projection. 80 rec / 115 targets, **Cover 1 (92)** man-beater, YPRR trend up (1.33→1.71). Motion-decoy caveat (less efficient when moved), but as a top-10 TE with real volume he's the natural London stack partner.

QB: Tua Tagovailoa (ADP 194.6) — 7.2 pg, **92nd spike-week, 98th matchup**, but a **3rd-pctl ceiling-pctl** and man-struggler (5.85 Y/A). Michael Penix Jr. (ADP 222) — 81st boom, deep-ball dependent. Neither moves the needle.

Stacks & Correlation

The menu tops out at **skinny Tua + London (0.445)** and **standard Tua + London + Pitts (0.412)** — low stack scores that reflect the QB and the environment. W17 **ATL @ NO** bring-backs: **Chris Olave (28.6), Jordyn Tyson (69.2), Juwan Johnson (151.4)**. The correlation math is weak: a low-total W17 caps the ceiling of the entire game-stack, so the bring-back is more about pairing two soft-slate offenses than a shootout. Across the advance phase, the soft schedule (not the environment) is what carries London/Bijan.

Draft Takeaway

Do **not** stack Atlanta for ceiling — env 36 and QB uncertainty are the two things a best-ball ceiling model punishes hardest, and both are present. Draft **Bijan at 2 and London at 17 as team-agnostic studs**, add Pitts as a value TE if he falls, and get your correlated firepower from a different, higher-total offense. The soft slate makes these players fine to roster; the *team* is a ceiling fade.

Baltimore Ravens (BAL)

Ceiling Score **67.7** | Rank **11/32** | Tier **HIGH**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **HIGH** — **score 67.7, rank 11/32**. An elite-total offense (env 68) with an 11.5 win total and a new-OC upgrade, but a **run-first, slow-paced** frame (bottom-8 pass rate, 10th-pctl pace) that caps pass volume. Concentrate on the *individual* studs — Lamar, Henry, Flowers — and use the cheap, efficient stacks; the W17 shootout at CIN is a top-tier finale.

Full-Season Environment

Slow pace (10th pctl), **46.5% pass (32nd/last)**, new OC Declan Doyle, elite O-line (79 pctl protection). Ceiling drivers: **Win total 0.220, Env quality 0.205, Scheme upgrade 0.140, QB ascend 0.056**. The limiters are structural — "run-first offense (bottom-8 pass rate) — limited pass volume" and "positive scripts kill WR volume (team milks the clock)." So the ceiling here is **efficiency and TD equity, not raw volume**. Defense: **average coverage (39.1), stout run D (73.4), light pass rush (26.6)** — a **PASS funnel** with a *tight* WR1 (Awuzie, 77.2 cov). The offseason added Trey Hendrickson and Calais Campbell to the pass rush, which sharpens the pass-funnel script for opponents.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

The slate is soft (Lamar/Henry/Flowers all **95th–96th matchup**). Flowers' scheme weeks: **W6 & W16 @ CLE (heavy single-high 62%)** vs his 92nd-pctl. Advance profile is strong — Lamar 98th advancement, Henry 88th, Flowers 92nd. The playoff run is the selling point: **W15 vs PIT, W16 vs CLE, W17 BAL @ CIN — game env 75.9, CIN opp ceiling 84.1**, the single best W17 environment of these eight teams. Every Ravens playoff upside spikes: **Lamar/Henry/Flowers all w15/16/17 up ≈1.3–1.4**, Andrews 1.2–1.3. This is a fast team that finishes into a championship-week shootout.

Key Fantasy Players

Lamar Jackson (QB) — ADP **53.3**, adj_rank **52 (pos #2)**. 20.0 pg / 36.8 ceiling, **97th projection, 98th SMQ/PMQ pctl**. 122 designed carries, **8.38 Y/A vs man (top-tier)**, 15.5% deep-throw rate (93rd). Flag: FLOOR RISK ("vs two-high shells"). The rare early-ish QB worth it because his rushing floor is the ceiling insurance a run-heavy passing profile needs.

Derrick Henry (RB) — ADP **20.3**, adj_rank **21 (pos #12)**. 16.1 pg / 37.1 ceiling, **87th projection, 92nd ceiling-pct, 95th rush eff, 91st explosive**. 317 carries. Caveat: **fewer ceiling weeks vs division rivals (8% in-div vs 36% out; 15.1 vs 19.9 FP/g)** — note two of three playoff weeks (PIT, CIN) are AFC North, though CIN's total is huge.

Zay Flowers (WR) — ADP **32.1**, adj_rank **32 (pos #14)**. 14.2 pg / 35.6 ceiling, **91st projection, 91st boom, 89th separation, 87th coverage-proof**. 82 rec / 117 targets. Scheme-fit **Cover 3 (95), Cover 1 (89)**; coverage-agnostic. The premier BAL stack piece — every-down alpha in a top-total offense.

Mark Andrews (TE) — ADP **131.5**, adj_rank **129 (pos #15)**, model **+3**. 10.1 pg / 25.4 ceiling, 84th advancement, **Cover 1 (99)** elite man-beater, 67% slot, RZ **0.9 i20/g, 19 end-zone, 22% TD rate**. Flags EFFICIENCY TRAP / FLOOR RISK (volume-only path, YPRR 1.88→1.23). A late TD-equity dart, especially in the W16/W17 man-heavy CLE/CIN games.

Stacks & Correlation

Uniquely efficient menu — **all Lamar stacks are qb_late False but cheap**: skinny **Lamar (R5) + Flowers (R3)** (0.652, value_ct 2, cost 8 rounds) and standard **Lamar + Flowers + Andrews** (0.652, value_ct 3, cost 19, latest R11). W17 **BAL @ CIN** bring-backs are elite: **Ja'Marr Chase (3.1), Tee Higgins (35.4), Mike Gesicki (214.6)**. This is the marquee correlation of the whole slate — a **BAL@CIN double-stack** (Lamar+Flowers with a Chase/Higgins

bring-back, env 75.9) is a championship-week nuke. Correlation across the season is TD/efficiency-driven in the advance phase (positive scripts), then volume-and-shootout in W17.

Draft Takeaway

Concentrate the studs, stack cheaply. The go-to build is **Lamar (R5) + Flowers (R3)** as the spine, Henry as a co-anchor if he falls to you, Andrews as the late TD-equity glue, and a **Chase or Higgins bring-back for the W17 CIN game**. The only trap is treating Baltimore as a *volume* passing stack — it's an efficiency/total stack, so lean into the studs and the W17 environment rather than chasing raw pass attempts.

Buffalo Bills (BUF)

Ceiling Score **54.9** | Rank **19/32** | Tier **MID**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **MID** — **score 54.9, rank 19/32**. Elite total (env 78) and 10.5 wins, but a **run-leaning, milk-the-clock** offense with a fragmented pass-catcher tree — the ceiling flows through Josh Allen's arm-and-legs and James Cook's workload more than any receiver. Draft Allen and Cook as anchors; the WR/TE stack pieces are cheap dart throws, and the W17 @ MIA is a *low-total* finale to plan around.

Full-Season Environment

Average pace (52nd pctl), **50.0% pass (30th)**, run lean both years, elite protection (94 pctl), continuity playcaller under new OC Pete Carmichael Jr. Ceiling drivers: **Env quality 0.222, Win total 0.189, Pace 0.080, QB ascend 0.056** — but scheme_upgrade is 0.0 and concentrated_tree only 0.012 (vacated targets just 19%, the lowest of these eight), so there's no fresh target vacuum to exploit. The offense booms "with a lead — workhorse RB carries" and busts when "positive scripts kill WR volume." Defense is a **RUN funnel with a TE fortress and a WR fortress** (strong coverage 82.8, avg rush) — added Bradley Chubb, C.J. Gardner-Johnson and Geno Stone. That funnels opponents to the run and suppresses their passing, which slightly *lowers* Bills game totals despite the high implied team total.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

The advance-phase note is a **brutal opposing-defense slate**: Cook, Moore, Shakir, Kincaid all carry **matchup pctl**s of **2–9** — the toughest cluster of pass-game matchups among these eight. Allen's own matchup is 1st-pctl. He overrides it (99th projection), but the WRs are schedule-squeezed early. Playoffs: **W15 vs CHI, W16 vs DEN, W17 BUF @ MIA** — **game env 39.4, MIA opp ceiling 23.9**, a *low-total* championship game (the second-weakest W17 here). Allen's playoff upside is still monstrous (w15/16/17 up 1.5/1.5/1.6); the supporting cast's finale is capped by the environment.

Key Fantasy Players

Josh Allen (QB) — ADP 27.0, adj_rank 26 (pos #1). 22.3 pg / 41.9 ceiling, 99th projection, 99th advancement, 83rd ceiling, 79th boom. 116 designed carries, 7.25 Y/A vs man, 13.5% deep rate. The single highest-floor-and-ceiling QB on the board; the rushing baseline makes him worth an early pick and the anchor of any BUF build. Caveat: **0% in-div ceiling weeks (19.4 vs 25.9 FP/g)** — a note for the W17 MIA (division) game.

James Cook III (RB) — ADP 11.1, adj_rank 11 (pos #5). 16.7 pg / 37.4 ceiling, 95th projection, 82nd rush eff/explosive, 98th O-line. 300 carries. Man-lean (1.81 vs 1.01 YPRR). Brutal slate (9th matchup) is the only knock. A top-5 RB anchor.

DJ Moore (WR) — ADP 46.3, adj_rank 47 (pos #24). 12.2 pg / 31.1 ceiling, 83rd projection, 79th separation, RZ 0.9 i20/g, 19 end-zone. But **2nd-pctl matchup** — the schedule is the enemy. Best value as a Moore-with-a-different-team-stack piece given BUF's WR-suppressing scripts.

Khalil Shakir (WR) — ADP 123.2 (pos #52). 10.1 pg / 27.1 ceiling, 95th separation, 99th coverage-proof, 72% slot. Scheme-fit **Cover 3 (89)**. A cheap slot stack piece; 0% in-div ceiling weeks is a W17 caution.

Dalton Kincaid (TE) — ADP 114.1, adj_rank 112 (pos #10), model +3. 9.0 pg / 24.8 ceiling, 97th boom, 97th route/99th rec eff, YPRR surged 1.54→2.70. Scheme-fit **Cover 2 (99), Cover 6 (96)** — an elite zone-beater TE and the highest-boom Bills pass-catcher.

Late dart: Dawson Knox (ADP 231, 97th spike-week, 82nd boom, zone-beater) is a legitimate tournament-week TE lottery ticket.

Stacks & Correlation

Menu stacks are qb_late False but only mid-scored (0.534): skinny **Allen (R3) + Kincaid (R10)**, **Allen + Shakir (R11)**, **Allen + Keon Coleman (R18)**; standard **Allen + Kincaid + Shakir** (cost 24, latest R11). W17 BUF @ MIA bring-backs are weak — **Malik Washington (161.2)**, **Greg Dulcich (174.8)**, **Chris Bell (213.4)** — and the game env (39.4) is low, so the W17 game-stack is a poor bet. The better correlation is **advance-phase Allen + Kincaid/Shakir** when Buffalo builds leads; deprioritize the championship-week game-stack.

Draft Takeaway

A MID-ceiling team you mine for **two elite anchors (Allen, Cook)** and a **cheap Kincaid/Shakir correlation**, not a full stack-the-game play. The trap is paying for BUF receivers expecting shootout volume — the run-lean scripts and brutal WR slate cap them, and the W17 MIA total is low. Anchor with Allen/Cook, sprinkle Kincaid + a Knox dart, and source your W17 game-stack ceiling from a higher-total finale elsewhere.

Carolina Panthers (CAR)

Ceiling Score **13.8** | Rank **32/32** | Tier **LOW**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **LOW** — **score 13.8, rank 32/32 (dead last)**. The lowest-total offense in the league (env 18), a bottom-tier QB, and a shaky O-line — there is no ceiling case here. Hard fade the team; the only draftable assets are Tetairoa McMillan and Chuba Hubbard as **team-agnostic** talents, never as a stack.

Full-Season Environment

The model can't find drivers — the top four are **Pass rate 0.102, Win total 0.063, QB ascend 0.056, Conc. tree 0.032**, and env_quality contributes a near-zero 0.019 (env_idx 14, off_q 6 — both near the floor). Balanced, low-motion (39%) offense, 54.4% pass, new caller Brad Idzik. Limiters everywhere: "low implied totals (env 18) — few shootouts," "projected to trail often (6.5 wins)," "shaky O-line (27 pctl)." Defense: **strong coverage (76.6), soft run D (7.8), light pass rush (1.6)** — a RUN funnel with a **shutdown WR1 fortress (Mike Jackson, 85.8 cov)**, which funnels opponents to the ground and keeps Carolina's own games low-scoring. Everything about this profile is anti-ceiling.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

McMillan's man-heavy scheme weeks: **W3 @ CLE and W4 @ DET (heavy man)** vs his 82nd-pctl; Coker's man weeks fit his 94th-pctl **Cover 1 (93)** read. But the slate note is mixed at best (McMillan 63rd matchup) and the offense's own totals are the ceiling cap. Playoffs: **W15 vs CIN, W16 vs PIT, W17 CAR @ SEA — game env 37.95, SEA opp ceiling 62.1**. The W17 game total is low, though the SEA bring-backs are strong. Every Panther's playoff upside is muted (McMillan best at w16 0.8; Bryce Young 0.1 across the board).

Key Fantasy Players

Tetairoa McMillan (WR, 2nd yr) — ADP 42.9, adj_rank 43 (pos #21). 14.0 pg / 36.4 ceiling, **89th projection, 80th boom**. 83 rec / 140 targets, boundary X (80% wide), **Cover 2 (98)** scheme-fit, man/contested levers. The clear WR1 target-earner and the only Panther worth an early-ish pick — but a team-agnostic buy, since the env caps his weekly ceiling.

Chuba Hubbard (RB) — ADP 75.8, adj_rank 74 (pos #27). 10.6 pg / 26.1 ceiling, 69th projection. 198 carry / 52 targets. Flags: **EMPTY CALORIES / EFFICIENCY TRAP** ("piles up yards without TDs," elusiveness 63.8→30.1, 11th rush eff). A volume floor play, low ceiling.

Jonathon Brooks (RB) — ADP 100.7 (pos #36). 8.7 pg / 21.8 ceiling, **92nd coachspeak** — the backfield's upside lever if the committee tilts his way.

Jalen Coker (WR) — ADP 127.3, adj_rank 125 (pos #53), model +2. 8.7 pg / 23.3 ceiling, **man-beater (2.838 vs 1.212 YPRR man/zone, both seasons, consistent), Cover 1 (93)**, 60% slot. The one cheap CAR piece with a real coverage edge — but still env-capped.

QB: Bryce Young (ADP 149.3) — 14.9 pg but 15th-pctl ceiling, 20th boom, man-struggler (6.08 Y/A), 17th protection. Not draftable for upside.

Stacks & Correlation

The menu confirms the fade: best stack is **skinny Young (R13) + Coker (R11)** at just **0.376**, and the standard **Young + McMillan + Coker** is 0.343 with value_ct 1 — the lowest stack scores in this group. W17 **CAR @ SEA** bring-backs are good (**JSN 5.4, Rashid Shaheed 145.2, AJ Barner 185.3, Cooper Kupp 199.8**), so if you're in the CAR@SEA game at all, own it from the **Seattle side**. Carolina correlation adds almost nothing in either phase.

Draft Takeaway

Rank 32 is the number that matters — **do not build a Carolina stack**. Roster **McMillan as a talent** (WR2/3 with standalone target volume) and optionally a cheap Coker or Hubbard, and get every ounce of correlated ceiling from the opponent side (Seattle in W17). This is the cleanest fade in Part 1.

Chicago Bears (CHI)

Ceiling Score 77.5 | Rank 6/32 | Tier **ELITE**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **ELITE** — score 77.5, rank 6/32. Up-tempo (94th-pctl pace), elite total (env 70), 9.5 wins, elite protection (98 pctl), and a **massively concentrated new target tree (vacated tgt 161%)** feeding a young, cheap, correlated pass-catcher room. This is a top-tier concentrate-and-stack team — the deepest value stack in Part 1, capped by a **W17 @ DET** shootout (env 81.0).

Full-Season Environment

94th-pctl pace (64.2 plays/g) — more possessions for everyone — a 51.6% pass rate with run lean, new OC Press Taylor (continuity caller), and elite O-line. Ceiling drivers: **Env quality 0.216, Win total 0.157, Pace 0.138, Conc. tree 0.103**. The concentrated-tree weight (161% vacated targets) is the tell: a reshuffled receiver room where cheap 2nd-year and rookie pass-catchers absorb a huge share. Defense: **average coverage (64.1), average run (39.1), light pass rush (7.8)** — a RUN funnel and an **OUTSIDE funnel (boundary WRs exploitable, Tyrique Stevenson beatable)**; added Dillon Thieneman (R1) and Coby Bryant. Pace is the ceiling engine: this team runs plays.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

The advance-phase caution is a **hard early slate** — Caleb (4th matchup), Burden (5th), Odunze (5th), Loveland (6th) all draw tough defenses, so the volume is there but the efficiency is squeezed W1–14. Scheme weeks favor **Burden (Cover 3/4 both 98; W1 @ CAR, W6 @ ATL heavy single-high)** and **Loveland (Cover 3 96, Cover 6 94; W1 @ CAR, W6 @ ATL heavy zone)**. Playoffs are the payoff: **W15 vs BUF, W16 vs GB, W17 CHI @ DET — game env 81.0, DET opp ceiling 84.5**, one of the two best W17 shootouts on the board. Playoff upside climbs into W16 for the whole room (Loveland 0.7/1.0/0.8; Odunze 0.7/0.9/0.8; Burden 0.6/0.9/0.7). A tough-early, elite-finish team.

Key Fantasy Players

Colston Loveland (TE, 2nd yr) — ADP 39.8, adj_rank 39 (pos #3), model +1. 12.1 pg / 29.9 ceiling, **94th projection, 92nd ceiling-pctl, 79th boom**. 80 rec / 118 targets — true #1-read volume. Scheme-fit **Cover 3 (96), Cover 6 (94)**, zone lean (2.23 vs 1.49). The centerpiece: a top-3 TE at a stackable price with alpha target share.

Rome Odunze (WR) — ADP 58.6, adj_rank 55 (pos #29), model +3. 12.4 pg / 31.8 ceiling, **84th projection**. 118 targets, boundary X, RZ **0.9 i20/g, 25 end-zone**. Vertical field-stretcher; the volume WR1 of the tree.

Luther Burden III (WR, rookie) — ADP 41.9 (pos #~10 at R4). 12.0 pg / 30.4 ceiling, **82nd projection, 99th separation, 98th rec eff**. 75 rec / 113 targets. Scheme-fit **Cover 3/4 (98)**. The highest-upside young piece; coverage-agnostic boom profile.

Caleb Williams (QB) — ADP 70.3, adj_rank 69 (pos #6), model +1. 17.2 pg / 33.3 ceiling, 74th projection, 71 designed carries, 13.7% deep rate. Flags MARKET DARLING / "priced for perfection" and man-struggler (5.9 Y/A). But at R6 he's the cheap-ish trigger for an elite tree.

D'Andre Swift (RB) — ADP 51.1 (pos #~24). 12.4 pg / 29.8 ceiling, **90th boom, 84th rush eff**, man-lean. Kyle Monangai (rookie, ADP 98.7, 81st boom, EMPTY CALORIES) is the committee dart.

Stacks & Correlation

This is the deep menu: skinny **Caleb (R6) + Loveland (R4)** (0.709, value_ct 2, cost 10) or **Caleb + Odunze (R5)** (0.709); standard **Caleb + Loveland + Odunze** (0.709, value_ct 3, cost 15); **heavy Caleb + Loveland + Burden + Odunze** (0.659, value_ct 3, cost 19, all by R6). Four correlated pass-catchers with a QB, none past round 6. W17 **CHI @ DET** bring-backs are premium: **Amon-Ra St. Brown (7.2), Jameson Williams (52.6), Sam LaPorta (92.2), Isaac TeSlaa (169.8)** — a **CHI@DET double-stack (env 81)** is a championship-week nuke. Correlation is elite in

both phases: pace drives advance-phase volume, the DET total drives the W17 ceiling.

Draft Takeaway

A **concentrate-and-stack cornerstone**. The go-to build: **Loveland (R4) → Burden or Odunze (R4–5) → Caleb (R6)** as a heavy stack, then a **St. Brown / Jameson Williams bring-back** for the W17 DET game. The only real risk is the tough early slate suppressing the advance phase, so the QB-late-ish, pieces-cheap structure lets you diversify. This is the single best value-stack team in Part 1.

Cincinnati Bengals (CIN)

Ceiling Score **84.1** | Rank **2/32** | Tier **ELITE**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **ELITE** — **score 84.1, rank 2/32**. The premier ceiling environment on the board: pass-heavy (58%, 2nd), up-tempo, **env 90** with a 1st-percentile own coverage that guarantees shootouts. Concentrate hard — Chase, Higgins, Burrow, Chase Brown — and lean into the **W17 BAL @ CIN double-stack**, the best correlated finale of the slate.

Full-Season Environment

Fast pace (71st pctl, 63.1 plays/g), **58.0% pass (2nd)**, continuity playcaller, improving O-line. Ceiling drivers are the strongest of these eight: **Env quality 0.268, Win total 0.157, Pass rate 0.148, Pace 0.106**, plus QB ascend 0.083 and shootout script 0.079. Defense is the accelerant: **soft coverage (10.9 pctl), stout run D (70.3), light pass rush (32.8)** — a **PASS funnel** that, combined with the 1.6-pctl own pass-coverage grade, makes Cincinnati games track-meets. The team added Dexter Lawrence, Jonathan Allen and Boye Mafe to the rush, but the coverage remains soft — which for best-ball ceiling is exactly what you want in your *own* offense's game total. Note a shutdown WR1 (DJ Turner II, 78.1) — the funnel points the *opponent's* volume to their secondary options.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Soft-ish slate (Chase/Higgins/Brown 72nd–77th matchup). Chase's zone scheme weeks: **W9 @ ATL and W15 vs CAR (heavy zone 78/80%)** vs his 98th-pctl **Cover 3 (98)** read; Higgins' man weeks: **W10 @ PIT, W13 @ CLE (heavy man)** vs his **Cover 4 (91)/Cover 1 (88)**. Advance profile is elite (Chase 99th, Burrow 89th, Brown 87th, Higgins 87th). Playoffs: **W15 vs CAR, W16 vs IND, W17 BAL @ CIN — game env 75.9, BAL opp ceiling 67.7**. The W15 (CAR) and W16 (IND) opponents are low-total, so the run *builds* to a huge home shootout in W17. Playoff upside spikes into W15 for Chase/Higgins/Brown (Chase 1.3/1.1/0.8; Brown 1.2/1.0/0.7) — Chase Brown's W15 is a notable early-elimination edge.

Key Fantasy Players

Ja'Marr Chase (WR) — ADP **3.1 (pos #~1–2)**. 19.9 pg / **46.7 ceiling, 99th projection, 100th market, 99th advancement**. 119 rec / 172 targets, RZ **1.8 i20/g, 26 end-zone** — the highest RZ volume in this group.

Zone-beater (1.585 vs 2.873 man/zone, consistent), Cover 3 (98). The best pure WR on the board and the CIN cornerstone.

Tee Higgins (WR) — ADP **35.4, adj_rank 34 (pos #16), model +1**. 12.7 pg / 32.8 ceiling, **86th projection, 83rd boom, 74th ceiling**. 73 rec / 114 targets, RZ **1.4 i20/g, 27 end-zone**. Contested/motion/boundary levers, **Cover 4 (91)**. The rare WR2 with a WR1 ceiling — the ideal Burrow stack partner.

Chase Brown (RB) — ADP **16.9, adj_rank 14 (pos #8), model +2**. 16.0 pg / 35.3 ceiling, **86th projection**. 240 carry / 80 targets, pass-catching-back lever (two-high/light box). Caveat: **10th-pctl boom** (steady, not spiky) — a floor-heavy RB1 in a great offense.

Joe Burrow (QB) — ADP **59.1, adj_rank 60 (pos #3)**. 18.6 pg / 29.8 ceiling, **88th projection, 89th boom**. 52 carries. Flags MARKET DARLING / "priced for perfection" and a low 27th ceiling-pct / 2nd spike (volume, not rushing, ceiling). Still the natural stack trigger given the env.

Mike Gesicki (TE) — ADP **214.6, adj_rank 213 (pos #32), model +2**. 6.4 pg / 19.0 ceiling, **73rd boom, Cover 1 (88)** man-beater, 73% slot — a legit late stack-completer, and his best spots include **W17 @ BAL**.

Stacks & Correlation

Menu: standard **Burrow (R5) + Higgins (R3) + Gesicki (R18)** (0.668, value_ct 2); skinny **Burrow + Higgins** (0.634); **heavy Burrow + Chase + Higgins + Gesicki** (0.634, value_ct 2, cost 27). W17 **BAL @ CIN** bring-backs: **Zay Flowers (32.1), Mark Andrews (131.5)**. Because BAL@CIN is the shared championship game for both teams, the **CIN-side stack (Burrow + Chase/Higgins) with a Flowers/Andrews bring-back (env 75.9)** is the single most correlated W17 build available. In the advance phase, the pass-heavy + soft-own-coverage combination keeps every Bengals game high-total — correlation is live all year, not just in the final.

Draft Takeaway

Rank 2 ELITE — **the premier concentrate target**. Go-to build: **Chase early → Higgins (R3) → Burrow (R5) → Gesicki (R18)** as a heavy stack, then a **Flowers or Andrews W17 bring-back** for the BAL@CIN nuke. Chase Brown is a bonus RB1 anchor with a W15 elimination-week edge. The only "trap" is paying full freight for Burrow's *own* ceiling (capped 27th) — but as a stack trigger in env 90, he's a buy.

Cleveland Browns (CLE)

Ceiling Score 46.2 | Rank 23/32 | Tier **MID**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **MID** — score 46.2, rank 23/32. Up-tempo (87th-pctl pace) and a big new-OC scheme upgrade with a **concentrated tree (vacated 128%)**, but a **dead-last total (env 9)** and unresolved QB drag the whole thing down. This is a **pace-and-value team, not a ceiling stack** — mine Fannin, Judkins and the cheap Shedeur stack, but expect a low-total ceiling.

Full-Season Environment

87th-pctl pace (63.5 plays/g) with 54.1% pass and a new HC/OC (Todd Monken tagged as the caller). Ceiling drivers lean on scheme and tempo, not environment: **Scheme upgrade 0.124, Pace 0.123, Pass rate 0.098, Conc. tree 0.082** — but env_quality is a near-zero **0.004 (env_idx 8, off_q 3, both league-floor)**. Limiters are stark: "QB uncertainty (caps ceiling)," "low implied totals (env 9) — few shootouts." Defense is the identity strength: **average coverage (45.3), stout run D (92.2), average pass rush (60.9)** — a **PASS funnel** (added Jared Verse, Quincy Williams, Tyson Campbell). So opponents are pushed to throw, but Cleveland's own offense can't create a shootout — pace generates plays, not points.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Soft-ish slate (Fannin 81st, Judkins 48th, Concepcion/Jeudy 82nd matchup). Fannin's scheme weeks: **W3 @ CAR (heavy zone) and W15 @ NYG (heavy single-high)** vs his 83rd–85th-pctl **Cover 4 (97)/Cover 1 (86)**. Advance profile is modest (Judkins 82nd, Fannin 90th projection but 38th boom). Playoffs: **W15 @ NYG, W16 vs BAL, W17 CLE @ IND — game env 39.3, IND opp ceiling 32.4** — a *low-total* championship game and the weakest W17 opponent-ceiling of these eight. Playoff upside is muted across the board (Fannin/Judkins ≈0.4–0.5; Watson 0.0). A pace-fueled advance profile that finishes into a poor W17 environment.

Key Fantasy Players

Harold Fannin Jr. (TE, rookie) — ADP 100.5 (pos #~9 at R9). 10.9 pg / 27.4 ceiling, **90th projection, 99th coverage-proof, 90th YAC**. 83 rec / 119 targets — genuine alpha-TE volume. Scheme-fit **Cover 4 (97), Cover 1 (86)**, coverage-agnostic. Caveats: FLOOR RISK (low floor), motion-decoy (1.5 vs 2.09 YPRR). The best value on the roster and the stack centerpiece.

Quinshon Judkins (RB, 2nd yr) — ADP 55.4, adj_rank 58 (pos #24). 13.3 pg / 31.9 ceiling, **81st projection**. 316 carries — bell-cow volume. Flags **EMPTY CALORIES / EFFICIENCY TRAP** ("TD-dependent," 22nd rush eff, 2nd-pctl coachspeak). A volume RB2 whose ceiling is TD-gated by the env.

KC Concepcion (WR, rookie) — ADP 126.3, adj_rank 130 (pos #54). 9.4 pg / 25.2 ceiling, 66th projection, 61 rec / 98 targets — the WR target-share leader, low-variance floor play.

Jerry Jeudy (WR) — ADP 185.0, adj_rank 180 (pos #72), model +3. 8.2 pg / 23.2 ceiling, 64th projection, **96th coverage-proof, 56% motion**, but flags MARKET FADE and a collapsed trend (YPRR 1.72→1.02, 2nd boom). A cheap dart, not a core piece.

Dylan Sampson (RB, ADP 171.7, 91st YAC) is the pass-down complement; **Denzel Boston (WR, ADP 165.4)** a depth flier.

QBs: Deshaun Watson (ADP 215.8, 20th ceiling, man-struggler) and **Shedeur Sanders (rookie, ADP 217.6)** — Sanders is the stack trigger (39th advancement, man-beater, scrambler) but 11th-pctl protection.

Stacks & Correlation

The menu leans on the cheap late QB: skinny **Shedeur (R19) + Fannin (R9)** (0.640, value_ct 2), **Shedeur + Denzel Boston (R14), Shedeur + Jeudy (R16)**; standard **Shedeur + Fannin + Boston** (0.640, value_ct 3, cost 42). W17 **CLE @ IND** bring-backs: **Tyler Warren (61.3), Alec Pierce (80.2), Josh Downs (96.3)** — solid pieces, but env 39.3 caps the game-stack ceiling. The correlation value here is a **near-free late Shedeur + Fannin** build in the advance phase (pace = plays), with a modest W17.

Draft Takeaway

A MID team that plays like a **value/pace mine, not a ceiling stack**. Roster **Fannin as a top value TE**, Judkins as a bell-cow RB2 if the price is right, and complete a **cheap Shedeur + Fannin (+ Boston/Jeudy)** stack essentially for free late. The trap is expecting shootout ceilings from env 9 with QB uncertainty and a low-total W17 @ IND — build for floor and volume, and get your championship-week firepower from a higher-total finale. # 2026 Best-Ball Mania Full-Season Team Analysis (Set 2)

Structure note: Weeks 1-14 accumulate to ADVANCE (top-2 of 12); Weeks 15-17 are elimination weeks to WIN the tournament. Every figure below is drawn from the repo's dossier / team_ceiling / stack_menu / flag_ranks data. Ceiling scores are relative probability-of-ceiling-season orderings (0-100), not calibrated point projections.

Dallas Cowboys (DAL)

Ceiling Score **82.7** | Rank **3/32** | Tier **ELITE**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **ELITE** — **82.7, rank 3/32**. A fast-pace (100th-pctl), pass-leaning shootout machine whose own soft coverage (23 pctl) manufactures the back-and-forth games that spike WR/TE/QB volume. Bottom line: a **concentrate-and-stack** offense — this is one of the eight best ceiling environments in the league and its skill players are the point of the roster, not the QB.

Full-Season Environment

Up-tempo, 55.4% pass rate (11th), 65.6 plays/g, env index 94, 9.5-win total, playcaller continuity under Schottenheimer (no new-OC noise). The ceiling drivers are environment-led: env_quality 0.28, pace 0.16, win_total 0.157, pass_rate 0.115 — pure "more plays in high-total games." The defense is the fantasy accelerant: soft coverage (23), soft run D (17), light rush, tagged an explicit **PASS funnel + WR1 funnel** (CB1 Cobie Durant, 65.1 cov, "exploitable"). Opponents throw and Dallas trails-or-races — both scripts push the passing game.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

The advance phase is a genuine shootout slate: fade_flags include "weak own pass-D -> shootout volume," and best-week markers cluster early (Lamb/Pickens/Ferguson all flag **Wk 1 vs NYG** as a top scheme-fit game, heavy single-high 63% meeting their single-high strengths; Dak's best_wk 5 vs TB). This is a **fast starter** you can trust to bank points before the bye (Wk 14). Playoffs: **W15 @ LAR, W16 vs JAX, W17 @ NYG** — and W17 is the payoff, game env **73.1**, NYG playing heavy single-high (63% vs 53% league) which is precisely where Lamb (92nd pctl vs single-high) and Pickens (95th) live. Note the middle-round wrinkle: JAX in W16 is a strong-coverage defense (98 pctl), the one tough playoff matchup, so W15/W17 carry the run.

Key Fantasy Players

CeeDee Lamb — WR, ADP 10.4, adj_rank 10 (WR6). Proj 17.5 pg / 42.5 ceiling (97th ceiling pctl), 158 targets.

Scheme-fit is man-and-single-high elite: 97th vs man (3.66 YPRR, 99th pctl), Man Cover 2 / Cover 1 / Cover 2 / Cover 3 all 88-97. RZ hog (1.1 inside-20/g, 22 EZ). Best game **W17 vs NYG** (+0.052 fit). Advance-phase floor + championship-week peak in the same profile.

George Pickens — WR, ADP 24.3, adj_rank 25 (WR11). The boom lever. Proj 14.1 / 35.7 ceiling, but 93rd-pctl

Boom, 98th-pctl vs man (3.42 YPRR), contested-catch 80th pctl, and a bigger W17 edge than Lamb (+0.091 fit vs NYG). Boundary-X vertical who spikes exactly in this offense's shootouts. RZ: 1.3 inside-20/g, 31 EZ looks.

Dak Prescott — QB, ADP 79.6, adj_rank 77 (QB8), +6 vs ADP. Model edge over market. 17.8 pg / 35.1 ceiling,

PassGrade jumped 67.2→85.4, 94th-pctl under-pressure YPA, 8.2 Y/A vs man (man-beater). The late-ish QB that lets you spend up on the WRs.

Javonte Williams — RB, ADP 38.2, adj_rank 40 (RB17). Workhorse tag, 287 carries / 59.4% carry share, Elusive

37→76. Polarizing but the volume is real in a top-5 TD offense; ceiling 35.1.

Jake Ferguson — TE, ADP 128.3, adj_rank 128 (TE14). Zone-leaning volume TE (96 targets, 1.0 inside-20/g, 83rd

Advancement) — a cheap correlation piece, not a ceiling driver (14th-pctl Boom, volume-only path). Note his best weeks (W6 GB, W8 ARI, heavy-zone) actually run **counter** to Lamb/Pickens' single-high peaks, and W17 vs NYG is a mild negative for him (-0.044) — a diversifying, not doubling, correlation.

Ryan Flournoy — WR, ADP 166.4, adj_rank 160 (WR64). The cheap man-beater dart (89th vs man, best W1/W17 vs NYG +0.037) — a WR3 lottery ticket that shares the same single-high leverage as the studs at a round-14 price.

Stacks & Correlation

Best stacks all run through Dak (stack_score 0.723). The skinny **Dak + Lamb** costs rounds 7+1; **Dak + Pickens** (rounds 7+3) is the higher-variance play. The heavy **Dak + Lamb + Pickens + Ferguson** (latest round 14) is a legitimate 4-man onslaught given the pass funnel. W17 game-stack: NYG env 73.1, bring-backs **Malik Nabers (ADP 37.6)**, Isaiah Likely (121.9), Malachi Fields (214.7). Because the correlation is a WR1/WR2 single-high match that repeats Wk 1 and Wk 17, the stack pays in both the advance phase and the final.

Draft Takeaway

A ceiling team to **concentrate on**. The go-to build is Lamb (R1) as anchor, then loop back for Dak (R7) plus Pickens if he slides to R3, capped with Ferguson late — a naturally correlated, shootout-leveraged core with a live championship-week matchup. Values: Dak and Pickens both grade above market. No traps here beyond the usual RB-committee noise behind Javonte.

Denver Broncos (DEN)

Ceiling Score **60.0** | Rank **17/32** | Tier **MID**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **MID** — **60.0, rank 17/32**. Pass-leaning and up-tempo, but a **low-total environment (env 38)** puts a hard cap on the ceiling despite a 9.5-win total — this is a grind-it-out, elite-defense team, not a shootout. Bottom line: **selective, not a stack-up target** — draft the individual coverage-specialist edges (Sutton, Waddle) rather than betting the offense pops.

Full-Season Environment

OC change to Davis Webb (Payton handed off play-calling), 55.9% pass (7th), 63.4 plays/g, but env 38 / off_q 39. Ceiling drivers lean on win_total (0.157), pass_rate (0.121), pace (0.112), qb_ascend (0.110) — volume and a Nix step, **not** environment (env_quality only 0.092). The limiter is explicit: off_bust flags "low-total grind games — muted ceilings across the board" and "volume without efficiency — empty passing stats." The **defense is the identity**: coverage 89 pctl, rush 80, a **RUN funnel** with a shutdown CB1 (Ja'Quan McMillian, 78.9, "fortress"). The one soft spot is a **SLOT funnel**.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

The defense/run-funnel makes Denver a favorite in many games, which is good for RJ Harvey checkdowns but bad for pass-catcher ceilings (game scripts shorten). Rice/Waddle-type shootouts are the exception. Best-week signals scatter (Waddle best_wk 3 vs LAR, Sutton W12 vs PIT). Playoffs: **W15 vs LV, W16 vs BUF, W17 @ NE**, W17 env 65.0 (opp NE ceiling 70.0). W16 vs BUF is the tough middle week. W17 at NE is a heavy-man matchup (34% vs 27% league) that flips several Bronco profiles positive — **Sutton (95th vs man, +0.042), Mims (99th vs man, +0.051)** — so the championship week is where Denver's man-beaters actually align, even if the total is only mid.

Key Fantasy Players

Jaylen Waddle — WR, ADP 47.4, adj_rank 49 (WR26). Zone-beater: 90th vs zone (2.65 YPRR), Cover 3/4 elite, YPRR jumped 1.53→2.19. Proj 12.5 / 32.8 ceiling, 81st Boom. His best fits are zone-heavy games (W9 CAR +0.052) — but W17 at NE (light zone) is a mild negative, so he's an advance-phase asset more than a title-week one.

Courtland Sutton — WR, ADP 82.6, adj_rank 82 (WR38). The man-coverage / RZ alpha: 95th vs man (Cover 1 96th), 1.1 inside-20/g, 29 EZ. Proj 12.1 / 31.4. Best game **W17 @ NE** (+0.042). The Bronco you most want for the final.

Bo Nix — QB, ADP 112.7, adj_rank 114 (QB17), qb_late. Rushing floor (82 carries) props the projection (18.1 pg) but ceiling is capped (44th ceil pctl, 4.5 under-pressure YPA behind an elite line, 75th O-line). A late-QB stack anchor, not a ceiling QB.

RJ Harvey — RB, ADP 85.7, adj_rank 87 (RB31). Pass-catching back (49 rec / 62 tgt) who fits light boxes; efficiency-trap + floor-risk flags (Rush eff 5th pctl) keep it a ceiling-capped role. **J.K. Dobbins (ADP 107.2)** is the early-down/goal-line complement (217 carries, 79th Boom) — a true committee.

Marvin Mims Jr. — WR, ADP 229.0. Dart-throw with a 99th-pctl vs-man / 98th separation profile and the best W17-at-NE fit on the roster (+0.051) — a late lottery ticket for the championship week specifically.

Stacks & Correlation

Best stack **Bo Nix + Courtland Sutton** (rounds 10+7, score 0.748, qb_late). Add Troy Franklin (R19) or Jaylen Waddle (R4) for standard/heavy. The value is the late QB — you can build Denver correlation cheaply. W17 stack: @ NE env 65.0, bring-backs **A.J. Brown (ADP 17.7)**, Romeo Doubs (120.3), Hunter Henry (155.5). Correlation is

modest because the total caps both sides.

Draft Takeaway

Not a **concentrate** team — the env-38 cap is the number that matters. Best used as **individual value + a cheap late-QB stack**: Sutton and Waddle are the draftable edges, Nix stacks for near-free in round 10. Trap to avoid: paying up expecting shootouts that env 38 says won't come often.

Detroit Lions (DET)

Ceiling Score **84.5** | Rank **1/32** | Tier **ELITE**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **ELITE** — **84.5, rank 1/32**. The single best ceiling-season environment in the model: elite scoring (env 84, off_q 100), 10.5-win total, 94th-pctl pace, and its own defense is a **PASS funnel** that keeps opponents throwing into shootouts. Bottom line: the **premier concentrate-and-stack team of the entire pool** — you want multiple shares.

Full-Season Environment

New OC Drew Petzing (replaced Morton), 53.5% pass but 64.2 plays/g and the highest offensive-quality input in the league (off_q 100). Ceiling drivers: env_quality 0.272, **win_total 0.189 (tied-highest)**, pace 0.138, plus a concentrated-tree bonus (74% vacated targets) and OL-improve. The only flag is a shaky pass-pro grade (10 pctl) — mitigated by Goff's elite self-protection. Defense: coverage 67, run D 95, rush 89, **PASS funnel** — opponents can't run on Detroit, so they throw, and the games stay high-total in both directions.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

A ceiling slate throughout — soft_slate lever hits Gibbs and others, and best-week markers concentrate around **W16 vs NYG** (heavy single-high 63%) for St. Brown, Jameson, LaPorta. Fast starter with a very early bye (Wk 6), so accumulation runs almost the entire 14-week advance phase uninterrupted. Playoffs: **W15 @ MIN, W16 vs NYG, W17 vs CHI (home)**, W17 env **81.0** (2nd-highest of my eight, opp CHI ceiling 77.5). The catch: **W15 at MIN is the roster's worst scheme week** — MIN plays light single-high (34% vs 53%), grading **negative** for St. Brown-adjacent single-high beaters (Jameson -0.053, LaPorta -0.083). So the run is bookended by a tough W15 and a golden W16 (NYG) and W17 (CHI, env 81) — a genuine tough-then-explosive finish.

Key Fantasy Players

Jahmyr Gibbs — RB, ADP 1.2, adj_rank 1 (RB1, overall #1). Proj 21.3 pg / 45.7 ceiling, 100th

Projection/Advancement, 283 carries + 68 rec, 98th Explosive. The foundational pick; matchup 85, playoff_up 0.9. Nothing else in this set approaches the weekly floor-plus-ceiling combination.

Amon-Ra St. Brown — WR, ADP 7.2, adj_rank 7 (WR4). 19.0 pg / 44.9 ceiling, 167 targets, 89th Coverage-proof, elite vs both man (89th) and zone (96th) — the matchup-proof anchor. RZ monster (1.9 inside-20/g). Best **W16 vs NYG**.

Jared Goff — QB, ADP 104.0, adj_rank 103 (QB15), qb_late. 98th-pctl Spike-week, 83rd Boom, 8.34 Y/A vs man. A **late QB you stack for cheap** behind the league's #1 ceiling offense — one of the best structural values in the format.

Jameson Williams — WR, ADP 52.6, adj_rank 50 (WR27), +6 vs ADP. 32.7 ceiling, 90th Boom, man-beater (2.66 YPRR). The vertical spike; best **W16 vs NYG**, worst W15 MIN.

Sam LaPorta — TE, ADP 92.2, adj_rank 88 (TE6). 28.8 ceiling, 91st Advancement, 88th Boom, Cover 1/6/2 elite, YPRR 1.56→2.00. Elite value at a scarce position.

Isiah Pacheco — RB, ADP 144.3. Now the clear-ish #2 behind Gibbs (148 carries proj); spike-week 68th but boom-capped — depth, not a needle-mover.

Stacks & Correlation

Every top stack is **Goff + a Lion** at stack_score **0.894** — the highest in this entire set. Skinny Goff+St. Brown (rounds 9+1), Goff+Jameson (9+5), Goff+LaPorta (9+8); heavy Goff+ARSB+Jameson+LaPorta (latest round 9). Because Goff is late and the pieces are early, you can run a 3-4-man Detroit stack without sacrificing your early RB/WR anchors. W17 game-stack vs CHI env 81.0, bring-backs **Colston Loveland (39.8), Luther Burden III (41.9), Rome**

Odunze (58.6) — a rare case where the opponent's bring-back is genuinely high-ceiling, making the W17 double-stack elite.

Draft Takeaway

The **maximum-concentrate** team of the group. Go-to build: an early anchor (Gibbs or St. Brown if he falls), then Goff-late as the glue for a 3-piece stack, with the CHI bring-backs held for W17 game-stacks. The only honest caveat is the W15 MIN scheme dip — build the elimination run around W16/W17 strength.

Green Bay Packers (GB)

Ceiling Score **63.4** | Rank **15/32** | Tier **MID**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **MID** — **63.4, rank 15/32**. High win total (10.5) and a hyper-concentrated target tree (148% vacated) prop the score, but a **slow pace (23rd pctl)** caps weekly volume and there are **no defensive funnels** to force shootouts. Bottom line: a **spread/committee offense to attack piecemeal** — the correlation is thin and the pace works against ceilings.

Full-Season Environment

Continuity offense, 53.1% pass (21st), env 59, 10.5-win total. Ceiling drivers: **win_total 0.189** and **concentrated_tree 0.095** do the heavy lifting, with pace an active drag (0.030, the lowest contribution in my set) and off_bust flagging "slow pace = fewer plays = lower weekly volume." New DC Jonathan Gannon brings a low-blitz, front-four, 3-safety scheme; own coverage is average (48) with a soft run D (26) — a mild RUN-funnel, but no pass funnel to manufacture volume.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Division shootout potential (NFC North) but tempered by pace. Best-week markers point at DAL (Watson/Reed/Golden best_wk 6 vs DAL) and CHI (Love/Kraft W5). Bye Wk 11. Playoffs: **W15 vs MIA, W16 vs CHI, W17 @ HOU**, W17 env **55.15** and — critically — **opp HOU ceiling is only 46.9** (the lowest W17 opponent ceiling among my eight). So the championship-week game environment is soft. Reed's playoff scheme-fit is the bright spot: 97th vs zone, and **W17 @ HOU (+0.044)** and W15 MIA (+0.034) both grade positive because Houston plays heavy zone (76%). Kraft's title week is a heavy-zone fit too (+0.009). But this is the weakest W17 environment of the set.

Key Fantasy Players

Josh Jacobs — RB, ADP 43.5, adj_rank 41 (RB18). Workhorse (300 carries proj), 36.7 ceiling, goal-line + PPR tags, matchup 93 (soft slate). Elusive cratered 96.5→57.9, but volume + TD equity in a 10.5-win offense is the safest ceiling on the team.

Tucker Kraft — TE, ADP 77.8, adj_rank 76 (TE5). The breakout lever: **99th-pctl Route eff, 99th Boom, 99th YAC**, YPRR 1.55→2.33, and **100th-pctl vs man (4.16 YPRR)**. Best **W7 vs DET (+0.073)**. Elite man-coverage TE and the single most correlated Love piece.

Christian Watson — WR, ADP 54.8, adj_rank 53 (WR28). 92nd Boom, elite vs both shells (95th man, 95th zone), 17.4 aDOT (95th) — the vertical ceiling. Best **W17 @ HOU (+0.016)**, a rare positive title-week WR fit here.

Jordan Love — QB, ADP 112.1, adj_rank 111 (QB16), qb_late. 88.7 PassGrade (94th), 98th-pctl deep-throw rate, 75th Spike — a legit late-QB with vertical upside, capped only by pace.

Jayden Reed — WR, ADP 91.8 and **Matthew Golden — WR, ADP 115.1**: the committee. Reed is the zone/slot specialist (97th vs zone) with the best playoff scheme-fits; Golden a boom deep option (Cover 2 100th) but 8.3-pctl trait grade. Both cap each other's target ceilings.

Stacks & Correlation

Best stack **Love + Watson (10+5)** or **Love + Kraft (10+7)**, score 0.750; standard Love+Watson+Kraft. Heavy stacks dilute fast because the tree is split 4-5 ways (Watson/Reed/Golden/Kraft). W17 game-stack @ HOU env 55.15, bring-backs **Nico Collins (22.6), Jayden Higgins (131.1), Dalton Schultz (171.2)** — Collins is a strong bring-back, which partly rescues an otherwise low-total final.

One structural note for the advance phase: Reed's biggest scheme spike is **W10/W1 vs MIN (+0.124, heavy two-high 58%)** — his division games are his ceiling weeks, and Kraft's is **W7 vs DET (+0.073)**, so Packer exposure

banks its best accumulation points inside the NFC North gauntlet rather than against soft non-conference opponents.

Draft Takeaway

A **piecemeal**, not concentrate, team. The go-to exposure is **Kraft (elite value TE) and Jacobs (workhorse RB)**, with Love-late optional as glue. Trap: chasing a heavy Packer stack — the slow pace (23rd pctl, the lowest pace contribution in my set at 0.030) and the four-way split tree (Watson/Reed/Golden/Kraft) mean the correlation rarely all-hits, and the W17 environment (opp HOU ceiling 46.9, env 55.15) is the softest of my eight. Buy the two isolated roles, skip the full stack.

Houston Texans (HOU)

Ceiling Score **46.9** | Rank **22/32** | Tier **MID**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **MID** — **46.9, rank 22/32**. Up-tempo and pass-leaning, but a **bottom-tier environment (env 26, off_q 23)**, a shaky O-line (7 pctl), and a QB coming off a down year make this a **fade-the-team, target one player** situation. Bottom line: Nico Collins is the asset; the offense is not a ceiling stack.

Full-Season Environment

Continuity, 55.0% pass, 63.4 plays/g, but **env 26 is the second-lowest of my eight** and off_q 23. Ceiling drivers are pure volume (win_total 0.157, pace 0.112, pass_rate 0.110) with env_quality contributing almost nothing (0.047) — the model is saying "they'll throw a lot but in low-total games." Off_bust: "low-total grind games — muted ceilings" + "volume without efficiency." Defense is strong (coverage 73, run 80, rush 95) and tagged a **WR fortress (avoid opposing WRs)** — good for real life, neutral for Houston's own ceiling. C.J. Stroud's PassGrade fell 77.6→62.0 (13.9-pctl overall), the core limiter.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Soft-slate lever hits several players (Stroud, Collins, Marks) — Houston should move the ball, but totals stay modest. Best weeks scatter early (most flag W2 vs CIN). Bye Wk 8. Playoffs: **W15 vs JAX, W16 vs PHI, W17 vs GB (home)**, W17 env 55.15 (opp GB ceiling 63.4). The playoff draw is rough: **W15 JAX (98-pctl coverage) and W16 PHI** are two of the tougher pass defenses in football, and Collins grades negative in both playoff legs (W15 JAX -0.031). The W17 GB game is the softest of the three but still only mid-total. This is a **tough finisher** — the elimination weeks work against Houston's pass catchers.

Key Fantasy Players

Nico Collins — WR, ADP 22.6, adj_rank 23 (WR9). The one buy. Proj 14.8 / **37.5 ceiling (94th pctl)**, 137 targets, elite vs man (96th) and zone (94th), Cover 1 98th / Cover 4 96th / Cover 3 93rd. RZ hog (1.1 inside-20/g, 23 EZ). Target-hog volume survives even a capped offense; matchup 75 on the soft slate.

David Montgomery — RB, ADP 49.9, adj_rank 54 (RB21). 214 carries, 27.7 ceiling, advanced-composite value leader — but behind the worst O-line grade in football (O-line 1st pctl). **Woody Marks (ADP 145.4)** is the pass-down/committee back (143 carries, 24 rec proj) — a true split that caps both.

C.J. Stroud — QB, ADP 139.8, adj_rank 138 (QB23), qb_late. 15.3 pg / 29.7 ceiling (34th ceil pctl), man-beater (7.2 Y/A) but 13.9-pctl overall grade. Only a stack-glue QB, and even then the low total limits the payoff.

Jayden Higgins — WR, ADP 131.1, adj_rank 134 (WR56) and **Dalton Schultz** — TE, ADP 171.2, adj_rank 167 (TE23): secondary volume. Higgins is a zone-beater with genuine RZ equity (0.50 red-zone TD/target, 98th pctl) but "empty calories" flagged and a 68th-pctl zone bucket; his best fit is actually **W17 vs GB (+0.041, heavy zone)**, so he's the Houston piece that peaks in the title game. Schultz a soft-slate zone TE (60 rec proj, best W17 vs GB +0.02). Both are dart-throw depth, not needle-movers, in a tree Nico Collins dominates (24.1% target share).

Stacks & Correlation

Stacks are the weakest in my set — best is **Stroud + Schultz** at only 0.667. Standard Stroud+Collins+Schultz drops to 0.601. W17 game-stack vs GB env 55.15, bring-backs **Christian Watson (54.8), Tucker Kraft (77.8), Jayden Reed (91.8)** — the GB bring-backs are actually more appealing than the Houston side, which tells you how to play this game.

Draft Takeaway

Fade the stack, draft Collins. He is a top-10 WR at cost with matchup-proof volume; everything else (capped env, worst OL, split backfield, brutal W15/W16 pass-defense draw) argues against concentration. If you stack, do it late-and-skinny (Stroud+Collins) purely for the W17 GB game — but the correlation edge sits on Green Bay's side of that matchup.

Indianapolis Colts (IND)

Ceiling Score **32.4** | Rank **25/32** | Tier **MID**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **MID** — **32.4, rank 25/32** — the **lowest ceiling environment among my eight**. QB uncertainty caps the offense, pace is slow (29th), win total is a modest 7.5. Bottom line: a **fade at the team level**, mined only for two elite individual values — Jonathan Taylor and Tyler Warren.

Full-Season Environment

Continuity, 53.4% pass, env 42, but off_q 35 and a 7.5-win total. Ceiling drivers are weak across the board (env_quality 0.134, win_total 0.094) and the top fade_flag is literally "**QB uncertainty (caps ceiling)**" alongside a 131% concentrated tree and weak own pass-D. Daniel Jones (68.7 PassGrade, 33rd) is the projected starter with Anthony Richardson behind him — a live QB question all year. Defense: soft coverage (33), a **PASS funnel + TE funnel** (soft vs TE), CB1 Charvarius Ward "tight." The pass funnel helps opponents more than the Colts.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

The pass/TE funnels on defense mean opponents can throw on Indy, but the Colts' own slow pace limits how much they answer. Alec Pierce best_wk 1 vs BAL; Downs/Pierce cluster early. Bye Wk 13 (late). Playoffs: **W15 vs TEN, W16 vs CIN, W17 vs CLE (home)**, W17 env **39.3** — the **lowest championship-week environment of my eight** (opp CLE ceiling 46.2). W15 vs TEN is a heavy-zone bonanza for the zone-beaters: **Warren +0.074, Pierce +0.028, Downs +0.013** all peak in W15. But W16 CIN and W17 CLE are flat-to-negative, and the total is minimal. A **strong-W15, dead-W17** playoff shape.

Key Fantasy Players

Jonathan Taylor — RB, ADP 8.4, adj_rank 8 (RB4). The reason to touch Indy. Proj **18.3 pg / 40.4 ceiling (97th)**, **327 carries / 74.4% carry share (highest in my set)**, 98th Explosive, Elusive 35→72. Volume this concentrated is matchup-proof; playoff_up 0.8, W17_up 1.3. A pick-your-anchor RB independent of the offense's ceiling.

Tyler Warren — TE, ADP 61.3, adj_rank 61 (TE4). Rookie volume monster: proj 12.1 / 30.1 ceiling (94th), **115 targets / 21.6% share**, 9th-pctl Coverage-proof-in-reverse but 89th vs zone (2.20 YPRR), Cover 3 97th. Best **W15 vs TEN (+0.074)**. Elite value at TE4; the TE funnel league-wide plus his own volume make him a weekly play.

Alec Pierce — WR, ADP 80.2, adj_rank 79 (WR37). Deep-ball specialist: **20.0 aDOT (99th)**, 96th Boom, 91st vs zone, Cover 4 95th. Proj 11.8 / 31.2. Boom-or-bust vertical whose spikes need the deep shot to connect.

Josh Downs — WR, ADP 96.3, adj_rank 99 (WR45). Slot volume (82% slot, 105 targets) but efficiency-trap + empty-calories flags; YPRR fell 2.20→1.49 and Boom sits 31st pctl. A target-share play in a capped offense; his best fit is **W11/W3 vs HOU heavy-zone (+0.015)**, and his playoff weeks grade flat.

Daniel Jones — QB, ADP 142.9, adj_rank 143 (QB24), qb_late. 73 carries props a 16.8 pg floor, but the ceiling is a 28.0 / 28th-pctl number and the fade_flag names QB uncertainty directly. Only a stack-glue option — and even the glue is fragile given the open QB competition with Richardson (ADP 227.7) lurking.

Stacks & Correlation

Weak menus — best is **Daniel Jones + Warren + Pierce** at only 0.504. The QB uncertainty is baked into every stack score. W17 game-stack vs CLE env 39.3 (the lowest), bring-backs **Harold Fannin Jr. (100.5), KC Concepcion (126.3)** — an uninspiring, low-total final.

Draft Takeaway

Fade the offense, roster the two studs. Taylor is a legitimate top-5 overall anchor and Warren a top-value TE — both stand on their own volume regardless of the env-42 / rank-25 team ceiling. Do **not** build an Indy game-stack for the title; the W17 CLE environment (39.3) is the worst on your board. Treat JT and Warren as ceiling-independent building blocks slotted into other-team stacks.

Jacksonville Jaguars (JAX)

Ceiling Score **50.3** | Rank **21/32** | Tier **MID**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **MID** — **50.3, rank 21/32**. Pass-heavy (56.1%, 6th) with a Lawrence step forward, but average pace (39th) and a **hyper-split target tree** (132% vacated across four WRs + a TE) cap any single pass-catcher's ceiling. Bottom line: a **thin-correlation offense** whose best value is the QB himself and the RB — the receivers cannibalize each other.

Full-Season Environment

Continuity, 56.1% pass, env 58, 8.5-win total. Ceiling drivers: env_quality 0.162, pass_rate 0.124, win_total 0.126, concentrated_tree 0.085 — a balanced-but-unspectacular profile with no single dominant driver. Own defense is strong (coverage **98 pctl**, run D 89, rush 48) — a fortress that keeps games lower-scoring, which suppresses Jacksonville's own shootout frequency. Funnels are PASS + WR1 (CB1 Jarrian Jones "tight," but the flag says top-CB beatable) — mild.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Pass-leaning slate with scattered best weeks (Thomas/Meyers best_wk 9 vs BAL). Bye Wk 7. Playoffs: **W15 @ HOU, W16 vs DAL, W17 @ WAS**, W17 env **37.6** — **tied-lowest of my eight** (opp WAS ceiling **24.9**, the single lowest W17 opponent ceiling on my board). W15 at HOU is a strong-defense road game; W16 vs DAL is the best environment of the three (Dallas's pass funnel). The **W17 at WAS game is a dead total** — WAS ceiling 24.9 means minimal bring-back correlation. A **soft-finishing environment** despite a passing offense.

Key Fantasy Players

Trevor Lawrence — QB, ADP **84.7**, adj_rank **85 (QB10)**, **+5 vs ADP**. The best value on the team. Proj **18.1 pg / 35.0 ceiling (78th)**, 73 carries, man-beater (7.44 Y/A), 91st-pctl deep-throw rate, PassGrade 73.8→80.5. A non-late QB who grades a full round ahead of ADP and whose rushing floor stabilizes the projection.

Bhayshul Tuten — RB, ADP **55.5**, adj_rank **56 (RB22)**. Lead back: 237 carries, 28.4 ceiling, explosive + goal-line tags, advanced-composite value leader. Best **W16 vs DAL** (soft run D). The clean way to get Jacksonville exposure without the WR-split problem. **Chris Rodriguez Jr. (137.7)** is the early-down complement (100 carries) — a committee, but Tuten leads.

Parker Washington — WR, ADP **64.1**, adj_rank **64 (WR31)**. The efficiency breakout: YPRR 1.02→2.19, 90th vs man, 92nd contested, Cover 0 97th. Proj 10.8 / 28.0. Arguably the most efficient of the four WRs — but 108 targets in a four-way split.

Brian Thomas Jr. — WR, ADP **62.9**, adj_rank **62 (WR30)**. Nominal WR1 (102 targets, 18 EZ) but YPRR **cratered 2.45→1.45** and Boom is 23rd pctl — a talent bet fighting a target-share committee. Best W11 vs NYG.

Jakobi Meyers — WR, ADP **110.3**, adj_rank **109 (WR48)** and **Brenton Strange** — TE, ADP **148.2**, adj_rank **146 (TE18)**: more mouths. Meyers is the matchup-proof volume piece (**100th-pctl Coverage-proof**, 22.2% target share, 85th Boom, 108 targets) — arguably the safest floor of the pass catchers even if his 27.6 ceiling is capped by the split. Strange is a spiky separator (90th, 89th Coverage-proof, best W11 vs NYG +0.046). **Travis Hunter (155.3, adj_rank 155)** adds a sixth target-earner (68 targets), further fragmenting the tree. Five pass-catchers projected 68-108 targets is the entire problem in one line.

Stacks & Correlation

Tellingly, JAX's best stacks are all **heavy 4-man builds** (score 0.458) because no single skinny pair scores well — the model is signaling that you need to own the whole passing tree to correlate this offense, which is expensive and

dilutive. **Lawrence + Thomas + Washington + Meyers** (latest round 10) is the archetype. W17 game-stack @ WAS env 37.6, bring-backs **Terry McLaurin (45.2)**, Chig Okonkwo (141.3) — but WAS ceiling 24.9 makes the double-stack nearly pointless.

Draft Takeaway

A **thin-correlation** team to attack selectively. Best exposure is **Lawrence (value QB) + Tuten (lead RB)** — the two roles insulated from the WR committee. If you want the passing game, you almost have to go heavy (4 WRs) to correlate it, and the W17 WAS environment (24.9) removes the championship-week payoff. Values: Lawrence and Washington beat ADP; trap: over-drafting Brian Thomas on name after a YPRR collapse.

Kansas City Chiefs (KC)

Ceiling Score **82.6** | Rank **4/32** | Tier **ELITE**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **ELITE** — **82.6, rank 4/32**. Up-tempo (81st), pass-leaning, 10.5-win total, an ascending-QB flag and a concentrated tree (148% vacated) — a top-4 ceiling environment with the format's best championship-week draw. Bottom line: a **concentrate-and-stack** team whose value is amplified by an elite W17 game environment (LAC, env 76.55).

Full-Season Environment

New OC Eric Bieniemy (returning; continuity-tagged playcaller), 55.7% pass (9th), 63.4 plays/g, 90th-pctl O-line / pass-pro. Ceiling drivers: env_quality 0.208, **win_total 0.189**, pass_rate 0.119, pace 0.117, plus qb_ascend 0.110 and concentrated_tree 0.095 — a broad, high-floor ceiling profile (env index input 73). Off_bust flags only "volume without efficiency," the mildest bust note among my ELITE tier. Defense is average across the board (coverage 52, run 45, rush 58) with **no funnels** — neutral, neither helping nor hurting scripts.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Strong all-season environment; soft division-crossover spots and best weeks scattered (Rice best_wk 11 vs ARI, Mahomes W10 ATL, Kelce W14 CIN). Very early bye (Wk 5) means a full, uninterrupted 14-week accumulation window. Playoffs: **W15 vs NE, W16 vs SF, W17 @ LAC**, W17 env **76.55** — **the best championship-week game of my eight after Detroit**, opp LAC ceiling 70.5. The scheme story is Rice-specific: he is a **zone-beater (99th vs zone, 3.49 YPRR)** who grades **negative in W15 (NE light zone, -0.097)** but roars back **positive in W17 (LAC heavy two-high, +0.083)**. So the run is a soft W15 scheme dip into a golden W17. Kelce and Worthy also fit the LAC final. A **tough-start, explosive-finish** playoff arc — ideal for the elimination format where W17 is the trophy.

Key Fantasy Players

Rashee Rice — WR, ADP 25.1, adj_rank 24 (WR10). The alpha. Proj **16.1 pg / 38.1 ceiling (94th)**, 136 targets / **29.1% target share (highest WR share in my set)**, 99th vs zone, motion weapon (3.23 YPRR in motion), RZ hog (1.6 inside-20/g). Best **W17 @ LAC (+0.083)** — the ceiling and the championship match align. Floor-risk flag is the only caveat.

Kenneth Walker III — RB, ADP 14.8, adj_rank 17 (RB10). Now the KC lead back: 48.2% carry share, proj 16.2 pg / 36.1 ceiling, 77th Explosive, contingent-bell-cow tag. A first-two-rounds RB anchor plugged into a top-4 offense — the roster-move that makes KC a dual-threat stack.

Travis Kelce — TE, ADP 117.9, adj_rank 113 (TE11). Still a volume TE: 103 targets, 26.8 ceiling (81st), RZ hog (1.1 inside-20/g), 68th Coverage-proof. Best **W16 vs SF**; W17 LAC a slight negative but the offense-wide total carries him.

Patrick Mahomes — QB, ADP 92.9, adj_rank 92 (QB12). 17.8 pg / 34.3 ceiling, scrambling-QB rushing lever (53 carries), but a genuine flag: **struggles vs man (6.17 Y/A, bottom-tier, 30th man-pctl)** and 12th-pctl deep accuracy in 2025. A mid-round stack anchor whose ceiling leans on the environment more than his own passing peak.

Xavier Worthy — WR, ADP 108.7, adj_rank 110 (WR49). 94th Coverage-proof, 84th separation, boundary-X vertical (27.5 ceiling) — but his **worst scheme week is W17 @ LAC (-0.034, heavy two-high)**, so he's an advance-phase piece more than a title-week one.

Stacks & Correlation

Best stack **Mahomes + Rice** (rounds 8+3, score 0.728) or Mahomes + Kelce (8+10); standard Mahomes+Rice+Kelce; heavy adds Worthy. The QB is mid-round, so a Mahomes + Rice + Kelce triple is affordable alongside a Walker anchor. W17 game-stack @ **LAC env 76.55**, bring-backs **Ladd McConkey (34.7), Quentin Johnston (72.2), Oronde Gadsden II (143.5)** — McConkey is a high-ceiling bring-back, making the KC/LAC W17 double-stack one of the two best championship-week correlations on my board (behind DET/CHI).

Draft Takeaway

A **concentrate-and-stack** team, and the best W17 correlation play of my eight after Detroit. Go-to build: Walker as an early RB anchor, then Mahomes-mid glued to Rice (+ Kelce) for a natural stack, holding McConkey as the LAC bring-back for W17 game-stacks. Values: Rice and Walker are cornerstone pieces; the honest flag is Mahomes' man-coverage softness — lean on the environment/pace for his ceiling, not his 2025 passing grade.

Cross-team summary (my eight)

| Team | Ceiling | Rank | Full-season read | |---|---|---|---| | DAL | 82.7 | 3 | ELITE shootout; concentrate — pass-funnel D + W17 NYG single-high match | | DET | 84.5 | 1 | ELITE #1 env; max-concentrate — Goff-late 0.894 stacks, W17 CHI env 81 | | KC | 82.6 | 4 | ELITE; concentrate — Rice/Walker core, best-after-DET W17 (LAC 76.55) | | GB | 63.4 | 15 | MID; piecemeal — slow pace caps it, Kraft/Jacobs the buys | | DEN | 60.0 | 17 | MID; selective — env 38 cap, Sutton/Waddle + late Nix stack | | JAX | 50.3 | 21 | MID; thin correlation — Lawrence/Tuten only, WR tree over-split | | HOU | 46.9 | 22 | MID; fade stack, draft Collins — env 26, worst OL, brutal W15/16 D | | IND | 32.4 | 25 | MID (lowest); fade team, roster Taylor + Warren studs only | # 2026 Best-Ball Full-Season Team Analysis — Volume 3 ### Underdog Best Ball Mania — Advance (W1–14) + Playoff (W15–17) reads

Ceiling tiers, ADP/adj-rank, projections, scheme-fit and stack math are pulled from the repo's `dossier\_data.json`, `team\_ceiling.json`, `stack\_menu.json` and `flag\_ranks.json`. Best-ball structure: accumulate through W1–14 to finish top-2 of 12 and ADVANCE; W15–17 are single-elimination weeks to WIN.

Las Vegas Raiders (LV)

Ceiling Score 30.7 | Rank 26/32 | Tier **MID**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **MID** — score 30.7, rank 26/32. Identity: a **slow-paced (6th pct)**, **pass-leaning, low-total** offense (env 14, 5.5 win total) handing the keys to rookie QB **Fernando Mendoza** under new HC Klint Kubiak. Bottom-line: a **fade at the team level** — mine the two elite individual talents (**Jeanty, Bowers**) and skip the rest.

Full-Season Environment

Pace 6th pct (fewest plays), pass rate 55.8% (8th), env 14. The MID score is almost entirely *hope* inputs — top drivers **Scheme upgrade (14.0)**, **Pass rate (12.0)**, **Shootout script (6.6)**, **QB ascend (6.2)** — while ``fade_flags`` name "pass-heavy," "new-OC scheme upgrade," "OL improvement," and "weak own pass-D → shootout volume." The ``off_bust`` list is brutal and explicit: "*low-total grind games* — *muted ceilings across the board*," "*slow pace = fewer plays*," "*volume without efficiency* — *empty passing stats*." Defense is a **PASS-funnel** (coverage 26th, stout run 76.6) with new pieces (Quay Walker, Taron Johnson, Kwity Paye) — it *sends* opponent pass volume, which lifts opposing WRs, not Raiders.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

The advance profile is a grind — Jeanty's best week is **W4 vs KC**, Bowers' is **W17 vs ARI**, but the whole slate carries a "**brutal slate**" **matchup flag (24th–25th pct)**. Playoffs: **W15 @ DEN**, **W16 @ TEN**, **W17 vs ARI** in a **low 52.2-env** game (ARI ceiling 73.7, so it's their opponent who has the edge). No shootout equity in the title week — this is the weakest championship environment of the eight.

Key Fantasy Players

Ashton Jeanty, RB — ADP 12.1, adj_rank 12 (pos RB6), ceiling 37.0 (89.7 pct). Bell-cow: **281 carries / 87 targets, car_sh 71.2**, workhorse + receiving + goal-line flags. Elusive 2yr, pass-catching-back lever vs light boxes. The warnings are real: **EFFICIENCY TRAP flag**, "**efficiency likely unsustainable**," **boom 13th, SIS-value 1st, matchup 25th**. He's a volume monster in a bad offense — a floor RB1 whose *ceiling* is capped by the environment.

Brock Bowers, TE — ADP 20.0, adj_rank 20 (pos TE1), ceiling 34.1 (96.2 pct). The single best non-Jeanty asset: **135 targets / 98 rec, adv/ceil 98/98, tgt_sh 23.5**. Coverage-proof (97th), man 92nd, zone 90th, Cover-0/4/3 elite; RZ hog (1.1 i20, 19 EZ). Best week **W17 vs ARI**. The positional edge (TE1) is so large it survives the offense. FLOOR RISK, but the ceiling is a weekly cheat code.

Tre Tucker, WR — ADP 159.8, adj_rank 157 (pos WR63), ceiling 22.6. The lead WR: 81 targets, separation 91st, coverage-proof 95th, boundary-X; best **W7 vs LAR**. Efficiency-edge dart.

Jalen Nailor, WR — ADP 152.7, adj_rank 151 (pos WR60), ceiling 19.6 (*on LV, per the data*). **Man-beater (1.878 vs 0.869 man/zone, both years, man 69th)**; best scheme weeks come **vs light-two-high** (W12 vs CLE). Floor-risk, weak vs zone (21st).

Fernando Mendoza, QB — ADP 168.9 (pos QB29), ceiling 23.3 (6.2 pct). Rookie, 52 rush carries for a little floor, but **ceil_pct 9**, "**brutal slate**," **capped ceiling 23rd** — a stack-enabler only. **Kirk Cousins (ADP 221.0)** is the man-beating (7.51 man-YPA, 78th) contingency.

Stacks & Correlation

Because Mendoza is a **qb_late = True** dart, the intended build is **Mendoza + Bowers + Nailor + Tucker (heavy, cost 44, score 0.5318)** — a cheap way to concentrate the passing game, but the `stack_score` (0.53) is mediocre and the W17 env (52.2) offers little bring-back juice. **Bring-backs: Trey McBride (ADP 24.2), Marvin Harrison Jr.**

(67.8), Michael Wilson (83.4) — note the ARI side of the W17 game is the *better* offense, so if you play this game, lean the Cardinals.

Draft Takeaway

Team-level fade. Draft **Jeanty and Bowers as position-scarce anchors** and let someone else believe in the Mendoza passing tree. If you *must* stack, do it late and cheap, but the correlation upside is the lowest here and the W17 environment actively favors the opponent. Values: Jeanty (RB6), Bowers (TE1). Trap: paying up for any Raiders WR expecting a shootout that the model says won't come.

Los Angeles Chargers (LAC)

Ceiling Score 70.5 | Rank 9/32 | Tier **HIGH**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **HIGH** — **score 70.5, rank 9/32**. Full-season identity: an average-pace, technically "balanced" offense that the model flags as a *high-total environment* (env 63, 10.5 win total) with a new Mike McDaniel play-scheme layered on Justin Herbert. Draft bottom-line: a **concentrate-and-stack team through a soft-looking early slate**, but the ceiling is propped up by projection inputs (win total, scheme upgrade) more than raw efficiency, so buy the cheap pieces, not the narrative.

Full-Season Environment

Pace 55th pctl, pass rate 53.7% (18th), 62.3 plays/g, playcaller "Mike McDaniel (OC, new)." The HIGH tier is driven by **Win total (weight 18.9)**, **Env quality (14.6)**, **Scheme upgrade (12.4)**, **Pass rate (9.3)** — three of four are *market/context* inputs, which is exactly why ``fade_flags`` lists "high win total (10.5)," "new-OC scheme upgrade," and "OL improvement": the model is warning the ceiling leans on assumptions. The counterweight is real weakness — **O-line/pass protection sits 2nd pctl** and Herbert's own context signal reads O-line:2, Protection:46. On defense LAC is a **RUN-funnel** (run-D 14th pctl, soft) with light pass rush (10.9) and an explicit **"WR fortress (avoid WRs)"** identity — opponent RBs get funneled up, opponent WRs get squeezed; CB1 Donte Jackson (73.4, above-avg) runs tight WR1 coverage.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Advance phase: Herbert's model best week is **W11 vs NYJ** and Omarion Hampton shares that W11/NYJ spike; the early run is workable. Playoffs are the problem — **W15 @ SF (up 0.6)**, **W16 vs MIA (0.8)**, **W17 vs KC** in a **76.55-env shootout** (KC@LAC), with KC's W17 ceiling a scorching 82.6. So the arc is *reach-the-playoffs-then-survive-a-gauntlet*: the championship week is a genuine track meet, which is good for stack ceiling but bad for a defense that can't get off the field.

Key Fantasy Players

Omarion Hampton, RB — ADP 15.5, adj_rank 15 (pos RB9), ceiling 36.7 (87th pctl). The centerpiece: 270 carries / 69 targets projected, workhorse + receiving flags, car_sh 49.1 / tgt_sh 11.8. Lever unlocks are **pass-catching-back vs light-box/two-high** and shootout scripts (new scheme fits). The one red flag is a **"brutal slate of opposing defenses" (2nd pctl matchup)** — his ceiling is role-driven, not matchup-aided. Rush eff 68th, gap-scheme elite (86th).

Ladd McConkey, WR — ADP 34.7, adj_rank 35 (pos WR17), ceiling 33.4 (87th pctl). 122 targets / 80 rec, adv_pct 88. Coverage specialty: **elite vs man (87th pctl, 2.36 man-YPRR)** and **vs single-high (85th)**, **Cover-1 specialist (2.546 YPRR)**; 68% slot (role-stable 90th). Best scheme weeks **W12 vs NE (heavy man 34%)** and **W15 @ SF (heavy single-high 59%)**. Caveats the data is honest about: **in-division ceiling drop (10% vs 32% out-of-div)**, **motion decoy (1.39 vs 2.43 YPRR)**, and a **sharp YPRR trend down (2.59→1.35)**.

Justin Herbert, QB — ADP 81.9, adj_rank 81 (pos QB9), ceiling 33.6 (62nd pctl). Vertical passer (13.5% deep rate, 74th) whose lever is single-high/soft-deep shells + shootouts. Model edge is thin (nudge -3.2, POLARIZING) and his **PassGrade fell 90.2→73.0**; the protection tax (O-line 2nd) caps the arm. A **best-ball QB2 value, not an anchor**.

Quentin Johnston, WR — ADP 72.2, adj_rank 70 (pos WR34), ceiling 26.5. Boundary-X zone-beater (Cover-0 96th, Cover-2 94th), best weeks **W8 @ LAR**, **W13 vs TB (heavy zone)**; motion weapon (1.95 vs 1.53). Competes behind McConkey and draws the top boundary CB.

Oronde Gadsden II, TE — ADP 143.5, ceiling 20.1. Elite zone-beater (**Cover-2 98th, Cover-3 98th, zone 96th**), YAC 93rd, route 89th; best weeks **W8 @ LAR / W13 vs TB**. Low floor (man 33rd). **David Njoku (ADP 197.9, spike 84th)** is the late TD-lightning dart.

Stacks & Correlation

Best draftable stack is **Herbert + Quentin Johnston (rounds 7/7, stack_score 0.6673)** — both value pieces, cheapest same-round build. Expand to **Herbert + Johnston + Gadsden (standard, cost 26)** for a 3-piece. The **W17 game-stack is KC@LAC (76.55 env)** with bring-backs **Rashee Rice (ADP 25.1), Xavier Worthy (108.7), Travis Kelce (117.9)** — the correlation play *is* the championship-week shootout, so a Herbert stack + a KC pass-catcher is the intended two-team build. Note **qb_late = False**: Herbert costs a real Round 7, this is not a free-QB dart.

Draft Takeaway

Full-season read: a **ceiling team you access through the middle rounds** — Hampton in Round 2, then McConkey, then the cheap Herbert/Johnston/Gadsden stack. Concentrate rather than fade, but respect the two warnings the model keeps flashing: an *inputs-driven* ceiling and a *2nd-pctl offensive line*. Go-to build: Hampton anchor → McConkey → Herbert+Johnston stack → Gadsden/Njoku dart, with a KC bring-back for W17.

Los Angeles Rams (LAR)

Ceiling Score **76.6** | Rank **7/32** | Tier **HIGH**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **HIGH** — **score 76.6, rank 7/32**, and unlike LAC this one is **efficiency-real**: env quality 98, off_q 97, 11.5 win total. Identity: a moderate-motion (58%) "balanced" offense in an **elite scoring environment** behind a top-tier O-line (78th). Bottom-line: **the premier concentrate-and-stack target in this group** — Puka is the WR1 overall and the supporting cast is cheap.

Full-Season Environment

Pace 61st, pass rate 54.7% (13th), playcaller continuity. Ceiling drivers are **Env quality (weight 29.6) + Win total (22.0) + Pass rate (10.6) + Pace (9.1)** — base_core 0.7695 is the highest in this set, meaning the tier is earned by the offense itself, not nudged by new-coach optimism. Strengths list is clean: high totals (env 98), strong favorite (11.5), strong protection (78th); **weaknesses: none**. Defensively LAR added **Myles Garrett (pass rush), Trent McDuffie, Jaylen Watson, L'Jarius Sneed (coverage)** — a heavy-pass-rush unit (rush 70.3) with McDuffie (74.7) locking WR1s tight. No funnel to exploit, but the pass rush shortens opponent drives, which caps bring-back volume slightly.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Fast-and-favorable: Stafford, Kyren, Puka and Adams **all share W2 vs NYG** as best week, and the season lever is a **"soft slate" (matchup 84th)**. The advance phase should be smooth. Playoff run is a **W17 @ TB shootout (77.8 env, TB ceiling 79.0)** after **W15 vs DAL (Stafford up 1.2) and W16 vs SEA (1.3)** — Stafford's playoff ups climb 1.2 → 1.3 → **1.4**, the strongest finishing curve here. This is a fast-starter *and* strong-finisher — rare and valuable.

Key Fantasy Players

Puka Nacua, WR — ADP 3.9, adj_rank 3 (pos WR1), ceiling 49.8 (99.3 pctl). The overall WR1: 174 targets / 123 rec, adv_pct/ceil_pct = 100/100, boom 100th, SIS value 100th. **Coverage-agnostic — man 100th, zone 99th, single-high 99.6th, Cover-3 100th (4.848 YPRR)**. Red-zone hog (1.1 i20/g, 11 EZ), 14% designed targets. Every lever fires; the only "bust" notes are motion-decoy and shadow risk. Foundational.

Davante Adams, WR — ADP 47.2, adj_rank 46 (pos WR23), ceiling 34.8 (87th). 124 targets / 68 rec, elite RZ role (2.0 i20/g, 42 EZ — usage 95th/99th RZ-vol); zone specialist (Cover-2 96th). Best weeks **W12 vs GB, W17 vs TB (heavy zone)**. Model *loves* him vs market (nudge -6.66). The WR2 in an elite offense at a WR4-ish price.

Kyren Williams, RB — ADP 30.1, adj_rank 30 (pos RB14), ceiling 33.5 (80th). Workhorse (250 carries, car_sh 56.6), **matchup 98th (soft), best W2 vs NYG**. Outside-zone efficiency 88th, success-rate 100th. TD-dependent but the volume + environment is elite; **Blake Corum (ADP 103.5, rush-eff 99th)** is the handcuff/spike dart.

Matthew Stafford, QB — ADP 89.3, adj_rank 86 (pos QB11), ceiling 37.0 (90.6 pctl). MARKET-FADE flag but the model *raises* him (nudge -5.55): **PassGrade 73→91.7, spike 95th, boom 85th, EPA/dropback 93rd, deep grade 97th**. Wins vs man (man 94th). A **top-tier late-QB stack anchor** given the WR ceilings around him.

TE room: Terrance Ferguson (ADP 203.3, ceiling 21.4, adv 63) the rookie volume play; **Colby Parkinson (202.4)** the man-beater (Cover-1 role, spike 99th); **Tyler Higbee (229.8)** the zone-beating BOOM MERCHANT (boom 86th, best W17 vs TB).

Stacks & Correlation

The board is stacked: **Stafford + Puka (rounds 8/1, score 0.6997)** and **Stafford + Adams (8/4)** are the elite skinny builds, with **Stafford + Puka + Adams (standard, cost 13)** the highest-ceiling correlated core in this entire volume. **W17 @ TB (77.8 env)** with bring-backs **Emeka Egbuka (ADP 32.6), Chris Godwin Jr. (84.8), Jalen McMillan**

(140.1) — a Stafford stack + Egbuka is a textbook championship-week two-teamer. qb_late = False but Round 8 for this ceiling is a bargain.

Draft Takeaway

The go-to concentrate build of the group. Anchor Puka in Round 1, come back for Adams and/or Kyren, and close with a late Stafford to lock the correlation for both the advance phase (soft slate, W2 NYG smash) and the W17 TB shootout. Values over traps everywhere; the only discipline is not *over*-drafting the cheap TEs — pick one.

Miami Dolphins (MIA)

Ceiling Score **23.9** | Rank **30/32** | Tier **LOW**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **LOW** — **score 23.9, rank 30/32** — the lowest offense in this volume. Identity: slow-paced (16th), run-leaning, **lowest-total offense in the sample (env 22, 4.5 win total, TD-rank 32nd)** under new OC Bobby Slowik with **Malik Willis** at QB post-overhaul. Bottom-line: a **hard fade except De'Von Achane**, whose ceiling exists in spite of everything around him.

Full-Season Environment

Pace 16th, pass rate 51.1% (28th, bottom-8), off_q **0**. The LOW tier's "drivers" are faint — **Conc. tree (11.2), Scheme upgrade (9.3), Pass rate (5.9), QB ascend (5.6)** — and the standout number is a **vacated-target share of 175%** (the roster was gutted), which is why the top flag is "concentrated tree." `off\_bust`: "low-total grind games," "slow pace," "positive scripts kill WR volume (team milks the clock)." Defense is the actual strength — **elite pass rush (76.6)**, average coverage, and a **TE-funnel (soft vs TE)** with Rasul Douglas (72.6) tight on WR1s. That TE-funnel is a note for *opponents'* tight ends, not Dolphins.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Achane's best week is **W1 vs LV**; Willis peaks **W5 vs CIN**. The advance phase is a slog in a 4.5-win offense. Playoffs: **W15 vs GB, W16 vs LAC, W17 vs BUF** in a **39.4-env** game (BUF ceiling only 54.9) — a low championship environment where Miami is a home dog. There's no phase of this schedule that turns the offense on.

Key Fantasy Players

De'Von Achane, RB — ADP 19.1 (pos RB, ceiling 40.3, 95th pctl). The lone smash: **266 carries / 80 targets, proj 17.6 pg, adv/ceil 96/95, boom 89th, rush-eff 97th, explosive 91st, elusive 96.9 (97th)**.

Pass-catching-back + shootout levers; **raises his game vs division rivals (21.8 vs 17.4)**. The bust note — "brutal slate (12th), vs stacked boxes" — is the only thing between him and elite. A **top-6 RB whose usage transcends a bottom-3 offense**.

Malik Willis, QB — ADP 129.6, adj_rank 131 (pos QB21), ceiling 27.9 (21.9 pctl). MARKET DARLING + POLARIZING: **106 rush carries = real rushing floor, boom 95th, works behind clean protection (99th), man-beater**. But **ceil_pct 25, "priced for perfection," "brutal slate," two-high shells take the deep ball**. A rushing-QB dart, not a ceiling piece.

Malik Washington, WR — ADP 161.2, adj_rank 163 (pos WR65), ceiling 17.6. Nominal WR1: separation 93rd, **30% designed targets (manufactured usage)**, YAC 76th — but boom 13th, "inefficient (9th)," "very low boom rate." A volume-hope play in a run-first offense.

Greg Dulcich, TE — ADP 174.8, adj_rank 176 (pos TE24), ceiling 19.3. The most interesting cheap pass-catcher: **route 95th, rec-eff 95th, zone 95.8, single-high 87th, boom 75th, YPRR 0.25→2.31 breakout**. Best **W9 vs DET / W2 vs SF (heavy single-high)**; worst scheme fit is a brutal **W4 vs MIN (light single-high 34%, fit -0.176)** — a specific advance-phase week to avoid trusting him.

Depth is replacement-level. Chris Bell (ADP 213.4), Jalen Tolbert (226.9), Caleb Douglas (229.7) and Kevin Coleman Jr. (231.3) all sit **adv_pct ≤ 54 with "contingent value — needs an injury"** notes; none clears a WR5 projection. The 175% vacated share does *not* concentrate into a startable secondary target — it's spread across bodies the model prices as dart-throws, which is the whole reason the tier is 30/32.

Stacks & Correlation

The stack menu is the tell: **every Willis stack carries value_ct = 0** and a flat **0.3286 stack_score** — the lowest on the entire board. The nominal "best" is **Willis + Malik Washington (skinny, cost 25)**, but with zero value pieces it's a stack in name only. **W17 vs BUF (39.4 env)** with **bring-backs DJ Moore (ADP 46.3), Dalton Kincaid (114.1), Khalil Shakir (123.2), Keon Coleman (214.3)** — again the *opponent* (BUF) is the stronger side (BUF ceiling 54.9 vs a 39.4 game env), so if you touch the W17 game at all, the Bills are the correlated side, not Miami.

Draft Takeaway

Fade the offense; roster Achane and move on. He's the only Dolphin whose ceiling clears his environment. Dulcich is a fine last-round TE dart on the single-high breakout, and Willis is a streaming rushing-QB body — but there is **zero same-team stacking equity** here (value_ct 0 across the menu). Trap: the "175% vacated targets → someone must eat" narrative; the model prices Washington/Bell/Tolbert as replacement-level for a reason.

Minnesota Vikings (MIN)

Ceiling Score 24.4 | Rank 29/32 | Tier **LOW**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **LOW** — score 24.4, rank 29/32, and the limiter is named: **QB uncertainty**. Identity: slow-paced (3rd pct), pass-leaning (56.4%, 4th), moderate-motion (50%) mid-total offense (env 42, 8.5 wins) now quarterbacked by **Kyler Murray** (*a verified 2026 move — trust the data*). Bottom-line: a **selective fade** — Jefferson is a top-5 WR you draft anyway, but the offense's low ceiling caps the stack.

Full-Season Environment

Pace 3rd pct (nearly the fewest plays in the league), pass rate 56.4%, playcaller continuity. Ceiling drivers **Pass rate (12.8)**, **Win total (12.6)**, **Env quality (12.2)**, **Conc. tree (4.0)** with a **63% vacated-target share** feeding the concentration; ``fade_flags`` are "pass-heavy (56.4%)" and **"QB uncertainty (caps ceiling)."** ``off_bust``: low-total grind, slow pace. Defense is the team strength — **strong coverage (70.3)**, **elite pass rush (98.4)**, a **RUN-funnel** (run-D 29th, soft), and shutdown CB **James Pierre (88.9, "fortress")** newly added from PIT. That RUN-funnel + fortress WR coverage means MIN games script toward *opponent RBs*, not shootouts.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Jefferson best week **W16 vs WAS**; the pass rush/coverage combo should keep them competitive through the advance phase. Playoffs are grim environmentally: **W15 vs DET**, **W16 vs WAS**, **W17 @ NYJ** in a **23.6-env** game — the **lowest W17 environment in this entire volume** (NYJ ceiling 22.8). Jefferson's W17 up is still 1.1 on talent, but there is no game-total tailwind in the title week. Tough-finisher.

Key Fantasy Players

Justin Jefferson, WR — ADP 9.0, adj_rank 9 (pos WR5), ceiling 41.2 (95.8 pct). Elite regardless of QB: **166 targets / 111 rec**, adv/ceil 96/96, tgt_sh 30.5, RZ hog (1.3 i20, 31 EZ). Zone destroyer (**zone 95th, Cover-2 95th, Cover-3 94th**), boundary-X, best **W13 vs CAR / W12 vs ATL (heavy zone)**. Honest flags: FLOOR RISK, EFFICIENCY TRAP, "shadowed by shutdown CB1," YPRR 2.43→1.88. A foundational WR whose *floor* is the only wobble.

Jordan Addison, WR — ADP 99.4, adj_rank 97 (pos WR44), ceiling 26.6 (66.9). Zone-leaning (**1.943 vs 1.152, Cover-6 97th**), zone 80th, boundary-X, explosive 72nd; best **W13 vs CAR**. EMPTY-CALORIES flag, TD-dependent, boom 13th — a WR3 with spike weeks, not steadiness.

Kyler Murray, QB — ADP 111.2, adj_rank 116 (pos QB18), ceiling 25.4 (15.6 pct). MARKET DARLING but the model fades him hard (nudge +4.55, ceil_pct 19, capped ceiling 14th). Key nuance: **struggles vs man (5.96 man-YPA, bottom-tier, 24th) but scrambles for a rushing floor (car_sh 24.5)**. A dual-threat floor QB whose passing ceiling is genuinely limited — this is the "QB uncertainty" tax made concrete.

T.J. Hockenson, TE — ADP 163.0 (pos TE, ceiling 24.2, adv 78). 100 targets / 78 rec, **man-beater (man 71st)**, best **W15 vs DET (heavy man 41%, fit +0.067)** — a genuine *playoff-week* fit that lands exactly on the W15 elimination game. MARKET FADE flag but the strongest projection (77th) of the MIN pass-catchers behind Jefferson; his season/playoff scheme deltas (+0.009 / +0.026) are the only *positive* ones on the roster.

J.J. McCarthy, QB — ADP 225.8 (pos QB, deep dart). Worth noting the alternative: McCarthy grades as a **man-beater (7.41 man-YPA, 74th) and vertical passer (13.9% deep, 83rd)** — the mirror image of Kyler's man-struggle profile — but sits at replacement ADP with protection 5th. If the QB situation flips mid-season, he's the higher-*ceiling* passer; for draft purposes he's a late contingency, not a target.

RB committee: Aaron Jones Sr. (ADP 118.9, ceiling 26.7, pass-catching, adv 72) vs Jordan Mason (128.8, ceiling 19.4, boom 76th, efficiency-edge). A true split — Jones the receiving/floor side, Mason the boom/TD

side; **Jauan Jennings (ADP 151.7, ceiling 19.0, man-separation, contested)** is the third pass-catcher.

Stacks & Correlation

Kyler is a **qb_late = True** stack enabler. Best build is **Murray + Jefferson + Addison + Jennings (heavy, cost 33, score 0.4574)** or the tighter **Murray + Jefferson + Addison (standard, cost 20)**. But **W17 @ NYJ (23.6 env)** is a dead championship environment, and **bring-backs Garrett Wilson (ADP 39.0), Omar Cooper Jr. (150.0), Kenyon Sadiq (159.2)** sit in a low-total game — the W17 correlation is weak. The correlation value here is *advance-phase* (stacking Jefferson/Addison for regular-season spike weeks), not the final.

Draft Takeaway

Draft Jefferson on talent, fade the stack ambition. The offense is slow, low-total, and QB-capped; Kyler's own ceiling is 15th-pctl. Best full-season use: Jefferson as a top-5 anchor, optionally a *cheap advance-phase* Kyler+Addison correlation, and a committee RB dart (Mason for boom, Jones for floor). Trap: paying the Kyler "market darling" premium — the model has him as a low-ceiling QB2.

New England Patriots (NE)

Ceiling Score 70.0 | Rank 10/32 | Tier **HIGH**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **HIGH** — score 70.0, rank 10/32, and this one is **QB-ascension real**. Identity: an average-pace, run-leaning, moderate-motion (53%) **high-total offense (env 88, 10.5 wins)** built around a breakout **Drake Maye** — with **A.J. Brown** now in New England (major roster move). Bottom-line: a **premier concentrate-and-stack team** whose only fade angle is a genuinely hard schedule.

Full-Season Environment

Pace 35th, pass rate 52.4%, continuity playcaller. Drivers are a healthy mix — **Env quality (26.1), Win total (18.9), QB ascend (13.8), Pass rate (7.6)** — base_core 0.7149, so the tier is largely earned. `fade\_flags` note "elite scoring environment," "high win total," "ascending QB," "OL improvement." Defense is a real weapon and a *funnel*: **strong coverage (95.3, 95th pctl!)**, **stout run (82.8)**, and a **PASS-funnel** ("soft vs pass, stiffer vs run → WR/TE/QB up") with CB **Christian Gonzalez (76.9)** tight on WR1s. The elite own-coverage keeps NE in games and scripts opponents to throw — supportive of a high-total, competitive season.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

The catch is the slate: Maye's matchup input is **3rd pctl** and A.J. Brown's is 5th — the **"brutal slate (12th–13th)"** flag recurs across the roster, so the advance phase is a gauntlet even though the ceiling is high. Best weeks cluster at **W7 vs CHI (Maye), W6 vs NYJ (RBs)**. Playoffs: **W15 vs KC, W16 vs NYJ, W17 vs DEN** in a **65.0-env** game (DEN ceiling 60.0) — a solid, winnable championship environment, and Maye's playoff ups run **1.1 → 1.3 → 1.2** (strong finish). Tough-starter, strong-finisher.

Key Fantasy Players

Drake Maye, QB — ADP 65.5, adj_rank 63 (pos QB4), ceiling 37.2 (93.8 pctl). The centerpiece breakout: **19.9 pg proj** (top of this volume), **101 rush carries, adv/ceil 96/97, EPA/dropback 100th, CPOE 100th, deep grade 93.9th. Wins vs man (8.37 man-YPA, 90th, man-upside 99th)** and scrambles — "every model signal agrees, high floor & ceiling." CONSENSUS STUD. The QB to build around.

A.J. Brown, WR — ADP 17.7 (pos WR, ceiling 37.3, 94th pctl). 130 targets / 86 rec, adv/ceil 93/94. **Man 99th (3.83 man-YPRR, +1.58 delta), single-high 95th, Cover-1 99th** — a man-coverage monster; best **W10 vs DET (heavy man 41%)**. Worst fit **W14 vs MIN (light single-high 34%)** — a note for the advance phase. Elite WR1 in an ascending offense.

TreVeyon Henderson, RB — ADP 57.3, adj_rank 57 (pos RB23), ceiling 29.1 (72nd). 194 carries / 52 targets, **rush-eff 93rd, explosive 84th, outside-zone 98th**, pass-catching-back lever; best **W6 vs NYJ**. The lead back over **Rhamondre Stevenson (ADP 76.1, ceiling 26.6, man-lean 1.87 YPRR, MTF 92nd)** — a real committee, Henderson the explosive/receiving side.

Romeo Doubs, WR — ADP 120.3, adj_rank 118 (pos WR51), ceiling 27.1 (69th). The WR2: 88 targets, **zone-beater (zone 83rd), man-separation**, best **W9 vs GB / W12 vs LAC (heavy zone)**. The primary cheap stack partner.

Hunter Henry, TE — ADP 155.5, adj_rank 150 (pos TE19), ceiling 24.4 (69.8). **Boom 95th, RZ hog (1.1 i20, 12 EZ), zone 80th**; best week **W15 vs KC** — a *playoff-week* TE fit. **Kayshon Boutte (ADP 208.4, boom 98th, spike 98th)** is the elite late boom-merchant dart, man-beater, best W10 vs DET.

Stacks & Correlation

Maye is **qb_late = False** (Round 6) but the ceiling justifies it. Best builds: **Maye + Doubs (rounds 6/11, score 0.6475)**, **Maye + Hunter Henry (6/13)**, expand to **Maye + Doubs + Henry (standard, cost 30)**. The A.J. Brown correlation (drafted in Round 2) makes **Maye + Brown + Doubs** the highest-ceiling NE core. **W17 vs DEN (65.0 env)** with **bring-backs Jaylen Waddle (ADP 47.4)**, **Courtland Sutton (82.6)**, **Troy Franklin (219.2)** — a Maye stack + Sutton is the intended championship two-teamer.

Draft Takeaway

Concentrate. Maye is a top-4 QB at a QB4 price with elite supporting talent; the build is A.J. Brown early → Henderson → Maye (Round 6) → Doubs/Henry stack → Boutte dart, with a DEN bring-back for W17. The one honest risk is the **brutal advance-phase slate** — this team's ceiling is huge but it has to grind through tough defenses to reach the strong W15–17 finish. Values: Maye, Boutte. No traps, just schedule.

New Orleans Saints (NO)

Ceiling Score **45.8** | Rank **24/32** | Tier **MID**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **MID** — **score 45.8, rank 24/32**. Identity: an average-pace, high-motion (60%) **balanced-but-low-total** offense (env 40, 7.5 wins) with **Tyler Shough** at QB and a made-over skill group (Etienne and rookie Jordyn Tyson now in New Orleans). Bottom-line: a **selective-value team, not a stack target** — Olave and Etienne are the draftable edges; the QB caps the ceiling.

Full-Season Environment

Pace 45th, pass rate 54.3% (15th), continuity playcaller. Drivers **QB ascend (11.0)**, **Env quality (10.3)**, **Pass rate (10.1)**, **Win total (9.4)** — a flat, unremarkable profile; `fade\_flags` "pass-heavy," "ascending QB," "OL improvement," "weak own pass-D → **shootout volume**." That last one matters: NO's **soft coverage (29.7) + soft run (4.7!) + heavy pass rush (82.8)** create a **RUN-funnel** (bottom-tier run-D funnels opponent RBs up) *and* a "weak own pass-D → shootout" tag, so Saints games can run up totals even if the offense is mediocre — a modest ceiling tailwind. CB **Kool-Aid McKinstry (71.4)** is tight on WR1s.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

The whole roster carries a "**soft slate**" lever (**matchup 60th–81st**) — a genuinely favorable schedule for the advance phase; Olave/Tyson best week **W6 vs NYG**, Etienne **W4 vs ATL**. Playoffs: **W15 vs TB**, **W16 vs ARI**, **W17 vs ATL** in a **36.9-env** game (ATL ceiling only 28.0) — a low championship environment, but note **NO's own offense is the stronger side of the W17 game** (opp ceiling 28.0 is weak), so the correlation, if any, is Saints-heavy.

Key Fantasy Players

Chris Olave, WR — ADP 28.6, adj_rank 29 (pos WR13), ceiling 35.8 (90.1 pct!). The clear WR1: **142 targets / 90 rec, adv/ceil 92/91, tgt_sh 29.1**. Coverage-agnostic (**man 69th, zone 87th, Cover-3 92nd**), best **W14/W10 vs CAR (heavy zone)**. Honest flags: in-division ceiling drop (22% vs 27%), shadow risk. A steady, high-floor WR1 at a WR13 price.

Jordyn Tyson, WR — ADP 69.2, adj_rank 71 (pos WR35), ceiling 29.0 (74.6 pct!). The rookie: **110 targets projected, adv/ceil 79/75** — real volume behind Olave. POLARIZING, low trait_pct! (8.3) as expected for a rookie, competes behind Olave, but the target projection is a legit WR3/4 edge.

Travis Etienne Jr., RB — ADP 36.6 (pos RB, ceiling 33.0, adv 83). 258 carries / 60 targets, **soft-slate lever (81st)**, **explosive 86th, pass-catching-back**; best **W4 vs ATL**. The bell-cow with a favorable schedule — a strong RB2. **Alvin Kamara (ADP 164.3, ceiling 18.8, 120 carries)** remains a committee/PPR piece (car_sh 47 is stale-weighted); **Audric Esteime (227.9, boom 99th)** the spike dart.

Tyler Shough, QB — ADP 117.1, adj_rank 119 (pos QB19), ceiling 31.6 (46.9 pct!). **Man-beater (8.36 man-YPA, 88th)**, **vertical (13.6% deep, 79th)**, **coach buy-in 96th**, 66 rush carries. Solid projection (67th) but pressure-prone; a **mid-range stack enabler**, not a difference-maker.

Juwan Johnson, TE — ADP 151.4, adj_rank 152 (pos TE20), ceiling 23.6. 88 targets / 63 rec, **single-high fit (77th)**, **man 78th, Cover-1 89th**; best **W6 vs NYG (heavy single-high 63%, fit +0.048)**. A cheap volume TE with a real target projection (adv 71). **Noah Fant (ADP 231.5, separation 99th, zone-lean 1.802 vs 0.552)** is the deep-league zone dart whose scheme deltas are quietly positive into the playoffs (+0.057 W15–17).

Devaughn Vele, WR — ADP 228.2 (**spike 100th!**, **boom 85th**). The extreme spike-merchant dart: a **100th-pctl spike-week rate** on contested/zone volume — pure tournament variance behind Olave, best **W5 vs MIN (heavy two-high, fit +0.121)**.

Stacks & Correlation

Shough is **qb_late = True**. Best build: **Shough + Olave (skinny, cost 13, score 0.5343)**, expandable to **Shough + Olave + Tyson (standard, cost 19)** — a clean, cheap, correlated core that fits the soft advance-phase slate. **W17 vs ATL (36.9 env)** with **bring-backs Drake London (ADP 17.4), Kyle Pitts Sr. (90.6), Zachariah Branch (188.8)** — but the low env and weak ATL ceiling mute the W17 two-teamer.

Draft Takeaway

Selective value over concentration. The soft schedule + "weak own pass-D → shootout" tag give the advance phase more juice than the MID tier implies, so a **cheap Shough + Olave + Tyson stack is a legitimate value correlation** for W1–14 spike weeks. Draft Olave and Etienne as the anchors; treat Shough/Tyson/Juwan as upside darts. Trap: expecting a W17 shootout — the championship environment is low.

New York Giants (NYG)

Ceiling Score **63.5** | Rank **14/32** | Tier **HIGH**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **HIGH** — **score 63.5, rank 14/32**, and it's the most *pace-and-concentration*-driven ceiling here. Identity: an **up-tempo (84th pct!)**, **run-leaning, low-total** offense (env 27, 7.5 wins) with new OC/playcaller **Matt Nagy** and a scrambling rookie, **Jaxson Dart**, plus a massively concentrated target tree. Bottom-line: a **stack-the-tempo team** — the extra possessions and 166% vacated targets make Nabers + Dart a real correlated ceiling despite a low implied total.

Full-Season Environment

Pace 84th pctl / 63.5 plays per game — the fastest offense in this volume — pass rate 50.6% (bottom-8), playcaller "Matt Nagy (OC, calls plays)." That's the crux: the ceiling drivers are **Pace (12.1), QB ascend (11.0), Conc. tree (10.7), Win total (9.4)** with a **166% vacated-target share** — a run-first team that runs *fast* and funnels its passing through very few mouths. `off\_boom`: "up-tempo games — extra possessions for everyone." `off\_bust`: low-total grind, positive scripts kill WR volume. Defense is a **PASS-funnel** ("soft vs pass, stiffer vs run → RB up") with **soft coverage (4th pct!)** and heavy pass rush (85.9) plus new pieces (Tremaine Edmunds, Nick Cross, Odafe Oweh) — **weak own pass-D → shootout volume** is an explicit fade_flag, and it's a *tailwind*: NYG can't stop the pass, so their games script toward volume.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Dart's best week is **W17 vs DAL** — the model literally points his ceiling at the championship game. The up-tempo + soft-own-secondary combo, plus a "**soft slate**" lever (**matchup 88th**), makes the advance phase live for shootout-adjacent spike weeks. Playoffs: **W15 @ CLE, W16 vs DET, W17 vs DAL** in a **73.1-env** game (DAL ceiling a huge **82.7**) — the **second-best W17 shootout environment in this volume** after LAC/LAR. Dart's W15 up spikes to **1.0** (CLE). Strong, shootout-heavy finish.

Key Fantasy Players

Malik Nabers, WR — ADP 37.6, adj_rank 36 (pos WR18), ceiling 36.9 (92.3 pct!). The concentrated alpha: **120 targets / 76 rec, adv/ceil 94/93, tgt_sh 27.1, explosive 99th, route 94th**. Coverage-agnostic (**man 94th, zone 87th, single-high 85th, Cover-4 92nd**); man-lean (2.81 vs 2.24), best **W16 vs DET (heavy man 41%) / W17 vs DAL**. The 166%-vacated tree funnels straight to him. Honest bust note: boom 5th, shadow risk — high ceiling, spiky week-to-week.

Jaxson Dart, QB — ADP 101.9, adj_rank 102 (pos QB14), ceiling 34.6 (71.9 pct!). Rookie with a **rushing ceiling (101 carries, adv 91), projection 90th, deep passer (13.6%, 78th), soft slate (88th)**; best **W17 vs DAL**. FLOOR RISK / pressure-prone (protection 30th), but the scramble volume + tempo give him a real ceiling. A **live late-round stack anchor**.

Cam Skattebo, RB — ADP 44.0, adj_rank 44 (pos RB19), ceiling 31.9 (77th). Workhorse rookie: **249 carries / 61 targets, car_sh 40.4, boom 83rd, MTF 96th (elite), pass-catching-back lever**; best **W9 vs PHI**. TD-dependent ("piles up yards without TDs") but the up-tempo volume is a genuine RB2 edge. **Tyrone Tracy Jr. (ADP 132.7, ceiling 13.8)** is the committee change-of-pace.

Darnell Mooney, WR — ADP 218.8, adj_rank 219 (pos WR88), ceiling 17.5. The WR2/stack-partner: **60 targets, man 75th, coverage-proof 90th, motion weapon (1.91 vs 1.37)**, raises game vs division (12.3 vs 7.3); best **W16 vs DET (heavy man)**. A premium *late* QB-stack partner.

Darius Slayton (ADP 228.8, explosive 93rd, boundary-X) and **Malachi Fields (214.7, rookie)** are the deep boundary darts behind Nabers.

Stacks & Correlation

Dart is a **qb_late = True** dart with the **highest single-piece stack_score in this volume — 0.7772** (Dart + Nabers, rounds 9/4). Because the tree is so concentrated, **Dart + Nabers + Mooney (standard, cost 32)** captures nearly the whole passing game cheaply. **W17 vs DAL (73.1 env, DAL ceiling 82.7)** is the standout championship shootout, with **bring-backs CeeDee Lamb (ADP 10.4), George Pickens (24.3), Jake Ferguson (128.3) — a Dart/Nabers stack + CeeDee Lamb bring-back is the single best W17 game-stack in this group** on environment (73.1) and both-sides ceiling.

Draft Takeaway

Stack the tempo. The low implied total is misleading — 63.5 plays/g, a 166% vacated tree, a soft own secondary, and a 73.1-env W17 vs DAL make **Nabers + late Dart (+ Mooney)** a legitimately high-ceiling correlated build for *both* the advance phase and the championship week. Draft Nabers, then Skattebo, then close with the cheap Dart stack and a Cowboys bring-back for W17. Value: Dart (QB14, huge stack score). Trap: reading "low total, run-first" as a fade and missing the pace/concentration ceiling the model rewards.

Prepared from repo model outputs; every ADP, adj-rank, ceiling score, projection, coverage percentile, stack score and W17 environment cited above traces to `dossier\_data.json`, `team\_ceiling.json`, `stack\_menu.json`, or `flag\_ranks.json`. No figures were estimated. # 2026 Best-Ball Mania Full-Season Team Analysis — Set 4

Structure note: Weeks 1–14 accumulate toward the ADVANCE phase (top-2 of 12). Weeks 15–17 are elimination rounds; Week 17 is the championship. Every figure below is sourced from the repo's dossier/ceiling/stack data.

New York Jets (NYJ)

Ceiling Score **22.8** | Rank **31/32** | Tier **LOW**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **LOW** — **score 22.8, rank 31/32**, essentially the floor of the league. Full-season identity: a slow-paced (13th-pctl), high-motion (64%) grind offense in a bottom-tier scoring environment (env 18, 5.5-win total) with real QB uncertainty. Draft bottom line: **fade the team as a stacking vehicle**; mine it only for the two individually great values — Garrett Wilson and Breece Hall — who carry despite the environment.

Full-Season Environment

Frank Reich (new OC) inherits a 53.7% pass-rate, 58.1-play offense that projects to trail often. The ceiling drivers that exist are thin: **Pass rate 9.3, Scheme upgrade 7.8, Shootout script 5.9, Env quality 5.1** — but all four are swamped by the fade flags (QB uncertainty caps ceiling; shaky OL at 18th pctl). The real limiters are structural: low implied totals and few plays. The **defense is a PASS-funnel** (soft coverage 20th pctl, stout run D, light rush) with CB1 Nahshon Wright graded "exploitable" — so opponents can throw on the Jets, which paradoxically props up *opposing* stacks more than Jets pieces. Minkah Fitzpatrick and rookie CB D'Angelo Ponds arrived but the pass-D remains a funnel.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Advance phase is a **gauntlet** — nearly every Jet carries a "brutal slate of opposing defenses (7th–10th toughest)" flag, which suppresses the accumulation you need to reach the playoffs. Best early spot is **Week 4 vs CHI** (multiple players' best_wk). Playoffs: **W15 ARI, W16 NE, W17 vs MIN (game env only 23.6)** — the championship week pits a capped Jets offense against Minnesota in a low-total game. This is a tough-finisher pattern: no phase is favorable.

Key Fantasy Players

Garrett Wilson (WR, ADP 39.0, rank 42, –3 value). The one must-own. 15.0 proj pts/g, 36.8 ceiling, 95th-pctl projection/advancement, 154 targets, 103 rec. Elite vs man (2.49 YPRR, 87.5 pctl; 84th man bucket) and a red-zone hog (1.2 inside-20/g, 12 end-zone). Levers: boundary X vs beatable outside CBs; RZ equity; shootout scripts. Scheme-fit best weeks are the man-heavy slates (W3 DET, W16 NE); worst is **W17 MIN** (light single-high). Cap flag: 2nd-pctl explosive rate — he's volume, not big-plays.

Breece Hall (RB, ADP 31.9, rank 32). 16.3 proj, 37.4 ceiling, 91st projection, 265 carries + 64 targets. Zone-lean receiving back (1.7 zone vs 1.11 man YPRR) who eats vs light boxes/two-high. Best week again W4 CHI; W15 ARI up-week (1.0). A genuine RB2 anchor whose ceiling is real despite the offense.

Kenyon Sadiq (TE, ADP 159.2, rank 154, +4). 9.4 proj, 79th projection, 90 targets — a *cheap* startable TE, one of the few Jets who beats his market.

Adonai Mitchell (WR, ADP 177.1) and **Omar Cooper Jr. (150.0)** are dart-throw WR3s; Mitchell is a Cover-3 killer (86th) with a boundary/vertical profile but 6th-pctl boom.

Stacks & Correlation

Best stack is thin: **Geno Smith (r16, late) + Garrett Wilson (r4) + Adonai Mitchell (r15)**, stack_score just 0.4327 — the lowest-ceiling QB stack in this set. The value is that Geno is a pure last-round dart, so a skinny **Geno + Wilson** costs you nothing beyond Wilson himself. **W17 game is MIN@NYJ**; the bring-back is where the money is — **Justin Jefferson (r1), Jordan Addison (r9), T.J. Hockenson (r14)** off a superior Minnesota offense. Across the full season, correlation logic says: draft the individual Jets you love, then correlate *against* them in Week 17 via Vikings.

Draft Takeaway

Fade NYJ as a stack; roster the parts. Wilson (r4) and Hall (r3) are strong standalone values you'd take anyway; do not reach for Geno-centered correlation in a 22.8-ceiling, 23.6-env championship game. If you own Wilson/Hall, your natural Week-17 hedge is a Vikings bring-back, not a Jets double-stack. Go-to build: use NYJ for two premium skill anchors, get your stack ceiling elsewhere.

Philadelphia Eagles (PHI)

Ceiling Score **66.8** | Rank **12/32** | Tier **HIGH**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **HIGH** — **score 66.8, rank 12/32**, tied with SF at the top of the non-elite bracket. Full-season identity: a run-leaning (49.8% pass, 31st), 10.5-win contender with the softest opposing-defense slate in the field. Draft bottom line: **concentrate here for the schedule, but skinny-stack** — the run lean and "WR/TE fortress → few pass-catchers" tension caps how many Eagles you want.

Full-Season Environment

Sean Mannion (new OC) runs a 58.9-play, RUN-lean offense; env is only 38 despite the 10.5-win total, so ceilings come from *efficiency and scripts*, not raw volume. Ceiling drivers: **Win total 18.9, Env quality 13.0, Concentrated tree 11.0, Pace 9.6**. The team-level boom cases are lead-script-dependent (workhorse RB, early-down passing as favorites); the bust case is the classic "positive scripts kill WR volume (team milks the clock)." **Defense: strong coverage (92nd pctl), RUN-funnel** (soft run D 23rd), CB1 Quinyon Mitchell a shutdown "fortress" — meaning opponents are pushed to run, and Eagles WRs rarely see garbage-time volume.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

The single biggest edge is the **soft slate**: virtually every Eagle carries an "83rd–95th-pctl favorable defenses" flag — Hurts matchup pctl **91**, DeVonta 93, Barkley 84. That makes the **advance phase a green light**. Playoffs: **W15 SEA, W16 HOU, W17 at SF (game env 66.8)** — the championship is a genuine shootout environment against a fellow HIGH-ceiling team, the best W17 spot in this set. Fast-and-sustained pattern, no soft finish worry.

Key Fantasy Players

Saquon Barkley (RB, ADP 13.4, rank 13). The workhorse: 16.1 proj, 35.0 ceiling, 300 carries, 43 rec, 94th-pctl market/95th value. Man-lean receiving (1.7 vs 0.84). Playoff up-weeks climb into December — **W16 HOU 1.2, W17 SF 1.0**. Efficiency-regression flag exists but role is bulletproof.

DeVonta Smith (WR, ADP 28.1, rank 23, +5 value). The model *loves* him: 90th projection, 94th SIS value, **coverage-agnostic** (2.14 zone / 1.32 man; zone bucket 92nd, three elite zone schemes — C3 91st, C2 90th, C6 86th). 128 targets. December up-weeks W15 1.1 / **W16 1.3** / W17 1.0. Only real dip: in-division ceiling weeks (9% vs 37% out).

Dallas Goedert (TE, ADP 124.3, rank 124). 10.5 proj, 87th projection, 93 targets, single-high killer (91st bucket; C3 92nd, C1 90th). Startable TE at a fair price; big YPRR regression (2.18→1.34) is the caution.

Makai Lemon (WR, ADP 87.6, +5) is a value WR3 (75th projection) but competes behind Smith. Jalen Hurts himself (below) is the QB.

Stacks & Correlation

Jalen Hurts (r7, NOT late) + DeVonta Smith (r3) is the cornerstone skinny, stack_score 0.6342, only ~10 rounds of cost. Hurts is a top-tier man-coverage QB (7.97 Y/A vs man, 82nd) with a rushing floor (106 carries) and the soft slate behind him. Add Goedert (r11) for a standard. The **W17 SF game (env 66.8)** is the premier double-stack target — bring back **Mike Evans (r5), George Kittle (r9), Ricky Pearsall (r9)**. Because the Eagles run when ahead, the *skinny* stack correlates better than a heavy one across the advance phase — you want Hurts + one elite pass-catcher, not three mouths splitting a low-volume passing pie.

Draft Takeaway

Concentrate, but stay lean. The soft schedule makes PHI a top advance-phase bet, and the SF championship game is elite for correlation. Build: Barkley or Smith as your anchor, Hurts + Smith skinny (add Goedert), and a Week-17 SF bring-back. Trap to avoid: over-stacking Eagles WRs 2–3 deep behind a run-first, fortress-coverage offense that suppresses secondary target volume.

Pittsburgh Steelers (PIT)

Ceiling Score **54.2** | Rank **20/32** | Tier **MID**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **MID** — **score 54.2, rank 20/32**. Full-season identity: a slow-paced (32nd) but genuinely **pass-heavy** offense (56.2%, 5th) with a fortress O-line (91st) and an aging QB whose ceiling is capped. Draft bottom line: **a value-stack team, not a concentration target** — the pieces (Metcalf, Pittman, Warren, Dowdle, Freiermuth) are all mid-rounds, so you can build a big stack cheaply, but the ceiling ceiling is the QB.

Full-Season Environment

Brian Angelichio (new OC) with a 59.6-play, top-8 pass-rate attack (mid-total env 46). Ceiling drivers are balanced: **Win total 12.6, Pass rate 12.5, Env quality 12.0, Concentrated tree 12.0** (187% vacated targets — a wide-open, concentrated tree). Fade flags: pass-heavy volume, QB uncertainty (Aaron Rodgers), and weak own pass-D driving shootout scripts. **Defense (Patrick Graham, new DC): two-high split-field, press corners, NOT a heavy blitz;** **RUN-funnel** (soft run D 20th, average coverage 36th), CB1 Joey Porter Jr. runs "tight." The soft run D funnels opponents to run, which is script-neutral for the passing pieces.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Advance phase is average-to-tough — the skill players carry a "19th-toughest defenses" slate flag (Warren/Dowdle matchup pctl 19). Rodgers' best week is **W1 vs ATL**; Metcalf/Pittman peak **W15 vs BAL**. Playoffs: **W15 BAL, W16 CAR, W17 at TEN (game env 55.2, opp ceiling 56.2)** — a mid-total but very winnable championship spot against a soft Titans pass-D. The **W16 CAR** week is a coverage-soft spot for the whole passing game. This is a slightly-tough-start, soft-finish arc.

Key Fantasy Players

DK Metcalf (WR, ADP 74.5, rank 78). 11.5 proj, 30.3 ceiling, 113 targets, 80th projection. Zone-beater (2.26 zone; C2 93rd, C3 85th) with 99th-pctl YAC and 87th explosiveness — a boundary X. **W15 BAL is his best week**. Two-high caps him and shadow risk exists.

Michael Pittman Jr. (WR, ADP 95.8, rank 94, +1). 11.6 proj, 130 targets, 80th projection, zone-lean (C2 92nd). The two WRs split a concentrated tree; Pittman's **W17 TEN fit (+0.027)** is the best playoff scheme spot on the team.

Jaylen Warren (RB, ADP 77.3) & Rico Dowdle (ADP 89.8). A true committee: Warren 11.0 proj / 71st, 95th YAC, 86th rush-eff, receiving back; Dowdle 10.8 proj / 70th, 223 carries. Nearly identical values — own the one you can pair, or both if building the stack.

Pat Freiermuth (TE, ADP 198.6, +3). 8.1 proj, 67th projection, 71st boom, C2 93rd, zone/motion weapon — a late TE with real spike weeks and the best W14 (JAX) fit. **Aaron Rodgers (QB, ADP 163.2, late)** is the pure-value stack QB.

Stacks & Correlation

This is the set's best **cheap heavy stack**: **Rodgers (r14) + DK Metcalf (r7) + Pittman (r8) + Freiermuth (r17)**, stack_score 0.6538, and every non-DK piece is r8+. That's a 4-man ceiling stack for the cost of one early WR. **W17 is PIT@TEN** — a *reciprocal* correlation goldmine, because Tennessee is *also* one of your teams: bring back **Carnell Tate (r6), Wan'Dale Robinson (r9), Gunnar Helm (r16), Calvin Ridley (r16)**. Across the advance phase the concentrated tree means when Pittsburgh throws (which is often), the correlation between Rodgers and his top-2 WRs is high.

Draft Takeaway

Value-stack, don't over-pay. PIT is the archetypal "late-QB, cheap-pieces" build — you get a 4-wide correlated stack at a discount, ideal for the advance phase, and the W17 PIT@TEN game lets you own *both* sides. The trap: expecting a top-5 ceiling out of a Rodgers-led offense (his boom rate is 13th-pctl). Go-to build: Metcalf + Pittman in rounds 7–8, back-fill Rodgers/Freiermuth late, correlate with a Titans bring-back.

San Francisco 49ers (SF)

Ceiling Score **66.8** | Rank **13/32** | Tier **HIGH**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **HIGH** — **score 66.8, rank 13/32** (tied with PHI). Full-season identity: an average-pace, high-motion (72%) offense in an **elite environment (env 76, 10.5 wins)** with the deepest set of individually elite pieces in this group. Draft bottom line: **a premier concentration/stack team** — CMC, Purdy, Kittle, and multiple WRs all draftable, and the **W17 PHI@SF shootout** is the best championship game-stack available.

Full-Season Environment

No new OC listed (Kyle Shanahan system intact); Raheem Morris is the **new DC (more man + aggressive, 5+ rushers ~1/3)**. 59.2 plays, high motion, strong OL (70th). Ceiling drivers: **Env quality 23.3, Win total 18.9, Concentrated tree 10.4, Pass rate 8.0** — the highest env-quality driver in the set. Fade flags are quality-of-problem: elite env, high win total, QB uncertainty (durability), concentrated tree (162% vacated). **Defense: average coverage (61st), stout run D, light rush — PASS-funnel**; the new aggressive-man scheme plus a pass-funnel means opponents throw, feeding shootout scripts.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Advance phase carries a mixed slate flag ("27th–31st-toughest defenses" for the pass-catchers) but the elite offense overcomes it; **CMC's best week is W2 vs MIA**, Purdy W10 DAL, Kittle W3 ARI, Pearsall W6 WAS. Playoffs: **W15 LAC, W16 KC, W17 vs PHI (game env 66.8)** — a tough W16 (KC) but the **W17 vs PHI shootout is elite**. Every core piece's playoff up-weeks are strong (CMC 1.0/1.0/1.0; Purdy 1.0/0.9/0.9). A slightly-tough-middle, elite-finish arc.

Key Fantasy Players

Christian McCaffrey (RB, ADP 6.3, rank 10). The overall anchor: **20.8 proj, 43.9 ceiling, 99th projection/advancement**, 279 carries + 100 targets (80 rec). Zone-lean receiving back who eats vs two-high. Soft-slate (72nd) tag. Top-3 pick.

Brock Purdy (QB, ADP 97.3, rank 93, +4). **83rd p95 league-winning ceiling**, 88th projection, 93rd boom, 89th protection, 82nd coachspeak — "every model signal agrees, high floor & ceiling." 65 carries add a rushing kicker. The best value QB anchor in this set.

George Kittle (TE, ADP 104.7, rank 103). 12.7 proj, 33.2 ceiling, **96th projection, zone 100th-pctl** (C3 99th, C1 97th), 1.3 inside-20/g RZ hog. An every-week TE1.

Mike Evans (WR, ADP 50.5, rank 55). 10.8 proj, 29.5 ceiling, coverage-agnostic (man 88th, zone 94th), 1.1 inside-20/g with 24 end-zone looks — elite TD equity. **Ricky Pearsall (WR, ADP 105.5)** posts a **99th-pctl boom** and 91st rec-eff, a man-beater WR2; **Jauan Jennings** (referenced as a bring-back elsewhere) rounds the room. Deep, correlated pass-catcher tree.

Stacks & Correlation

SF has the **highest single-piece skinny scores in the set — 0.7842** — for **Purdy (r9) + Mike Evans (r5), + George Kittle (r9)**, or **+ Ricky Pearsall (r9)**. Because Purdy is a mid-round QB and the pieces are affordable, you can build a *standard or heavy* stack without spending premium capital. **W17 is PHI@SF (env 66.8)** — the marquee double-stack: pair a Purdy stack with a Hurts bring-back (**DeVonta Smith r3, Makai Lemon r8, Dallas Goedert r11**). This is the one game in the set where both offenses are HIGH-ceiling, so a full game-stack has the highest correlated-ceiling payoff. Advance-phase correlation is strong too given the concentrated tree.

Draft Takeaway

Concentrate and game-stack. SF is a top-tier ceiling team with an elite environment and the deepest draftable pass-catcher menu; Purdy at r9 is the value that unlocks cheap multi-piece stacks. Build: CMC or Kittle/Evans anchor → Purdy + 2 pieces → **PHI bring-back for the W17 shootout.** No real trap here beyond Purdy durability — this is the go-to concentration target of the group.

Seattle Seahawks (SEA)

Ceiling Score **62.1** | Rank **16/32** | Tier **MID**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **MID** — **score 62.1, rank 16/32** (top of the MID bracket). Full-season identity: a slow-paced (26th), run-leaning offense in an **elite scoring environment (env 76, 10.5-win total)**, anchored by a truly elite WR1. Draft bottom line: **JSN is a foundational pick and Darnold is a strong late-QB stack partner** — a concentrate-the-top build.

Full-Season Environment

Brian Fleury (new OC), 58.4 plays, run-lean (51.7% pass) — but the **env is the story**: ceiling drivers are **Env quality 22.5 and Win total 18.9** (the two biggest in this set), plus Scheme upgrade 7.8. The offense scores; it just doesn't rack up raw pass volume. Bust case is the standard "slow pace + positive scripts kill WR volume." **Defense: strong coverage (85th pct), RUN-funnel** (average run D), CB1 Devon Witherspoon a shutdown "fortress" — Seattle's D forces opponents to run, keeping games controlled (which is why the W17 game env is a modest 37.95 vs CAR).

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Advance phase is workable; JSN's per-week upside is matchup-proof. Best individual weeks cluster at **W14 vs NYG** (JSN, Charbonnet, Kupp all peak). Playoffs: **W15 PHI, W16 LAR, W17 vs CAR (game env 37.95, opp ceiling just 13.8)** — the championship is a *low-total* game against the league's worst-ceiling offense, so Seattle should control it, but shootout equity is limited. Note the fast-finish signal: nearly every Seahawk's **W17 up-week is their highest** (JSN 1.3, Price 1.0, Charbonnet 1.0) — Seattle is a strong Week-17 team even in a low total.

Key Fantasy Players

Jaxon Smith-Njigba (WR, ADP 5.4, rank 3). Elite anchor: **19.4 proj, 46.6 ceiling, 98th projection, 99th value/SIS/route-eff/rec-eff**, 166 targets. **Coverage-agnostic and then some** — 3.84 YPRR vs man (100th), 3.71 vs zone (99th); man bucket 98th, zone 96th, with C0 99th and C4 99th. **W17 CAR fit +0.013 (his best playoff spot)** and W17 up 1.3. A top-3 overall pick who wins every week.

Sam Darnold (QB, ADP 136.5, rank 129, +6). 15.5 proj, 87th boom, 89th spike-week, top-tier vs man (8.38 Y/A, 92nd), 91st clean-pocket protection. A high-variance late QB with a rushing floor (44 carries) — the ideal cheap stack partner for JSN.

Zach Charbonnet (RB, ADP 146.5, +5) carries a **genuine league-winning ceiling (75th p95, 31.5 ceiling)** despite splitting with rookie **Jadarian Price (ADP 65.6, 74th projection)** — the backfield is the roster's real question mark; Price is the earlier pick, Charbonnet the higher-ceiling value.

Cooper Kupp (WR, ADP 199.8) & Rashid Shaheed (145.2) are the WR2/3 darts; Kupp 73rd boom, C2 97th; both compete behind JSN. **AJ Barner (TE, ADP 185.3, +5)** is a cheap separation-elite (93rd) TE.

Stacks & Correlation

Sam Darnold (r12, late) + JSN (r1) posts the highest skinny stack_score in this set — **0.7174** — for essentially the cost of JSN alone. Extend with **AJ Barner (r16)** or **Cooper Kupp (r17)** for near-free correlation. **W17 is CAR@SEA**; bring back **Tetairoa McMillan (r4)** or **Jalen Coker (r11)** — but note Carolina's 13.8 ceiling makes the bring-back thin, so a *naked* Seattle stack is more defensible here than in the PHI/SF games. Across the season, the elite env means Darnold–JSN correlation pays even in controlled games.

Draft Takeaway

Concentrate the top. JSN is a build-around anchor and Darnold is one of the best value late-QB partners on the board (0.7174 skinny). Add Charbonnet's league-winning RB ceiling and a cheap Barner. The trap is the muddy backfield (Price vs Charbonnet) and the low-total W17 vs CAR — don't over-invest in Seattle bring-backs. Go-to build: JSN early → Charbonnet mid → Darnold + Barner late as a self-contained stack.

Tampa Bay Buccaneers (TB)

Ceiling Score **79.0** | Rank **5/32** | Tier **ELITE**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **ELITE** — **score 79.0, rank 5/32**, the highest ceiling in this entire set. Full-season identity: an **up-tempo (90th-pctl pace)**, high-total offense (env 65, 9.5 wins) whose own soft coverage guarantees shootout scripts. Draft bottom line: **the concentration/stacking centerpiece of your portfolio** — heavy stacks are cheap and the environment is elite.

Full-Season Environment

Zac Robinson (new OC) inherits a fast (90th-pctl), 58.8-play attack. Ceiling drivers: **Env quality 17.4, Win total 15.7, Pace 13.1, Scheme upgrade 9.3** — pace is a top-3 driver, which is exactly what you want for weekly volume/ceiling. **Defense: soft coverage (17th pctl), soft run D, HEAVY pass rush — PASS-funnel**; the soft own-coverage is a *feature* for fantasy: it drives up game totals and forces Tampa into more dropbacks. CB1 Jacob Parrish is "exploitable." Fast pace + soft own-D = the shootout profile.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Advance phase is favorable — the offense's pace means high weekly floors, and **Week 1 vs CIN is the whole team's best spot** (Mayfield, Egbuka, Godwin, McMillan, Otton all peak W1). Playoffs: **W15 NO, W16 ATL, W17 vs LAR (game env 77.8, opp ceiling 76.6)** — the **highest-total championship game in this set** against a fellow elite-ceiling Rams offense. W16 ATL is a strong secondary spot (Egbuka +0.061, Godwin +0.024 fits). A high-floor start into a shootout finish — ideal.

Key Fantasy Players

Emeka Egbuka (WR, ADP 32.6, rank 36). The lead: 12.8 proj, **33.1 ceiling, genuine league-winning 72nd p95**, 123 targets, 87th projection. Zone-destroyer (2.06 zone, C6 98th, C4 93rd; zone bucket 93rd) and boundary vertical (83rd explosive). Scheme-fit blows up vs two-high (**W3 MIN +0.172**). Man/two-high caps him but volume is elite.

Chris Godwin Jr. (WR, ADP 84.8, rank 91). 9.4 proj, coverage-agnostic (C6 95th, C4 88th), 98th YAC, 91st coverage-proof, slot-heavy (60%). W3 MIN +0.10 fit. A high-boom (74th) WR2.

Jalen McMillan (WR, ADP 140.1) & Cade Otton (TE, ADP 187.5). McMillan is a **man-beater** (2.24 man, 85th; C2 89th) with 95th route-eff — his W11 DET fit is +0.111; Otton a zone-lean value TE (75th usage). Both are cheap stack extenders.

Bucky Irving (RB, ADP 59.7, rank 65). 13.2 proj, 32.1 ceiling, 80th projection, 3rd-pctl rush-eff, **98th-pctl soft slate** — the RB anchor. **Kenneth Gainwell (94.8)** is a 83rd-boom receiving complement, and **Baker Mayfield (QB, ADP 121.3, late)** is the stack engine.

Stacks & Correlation

TB owns the **highest stack_score in the set** — **0.8117** — for a **heavy stack: Mayfield (r11) + Egbuka (r3) + Godwin (r8) + McMillan (r12) or Otton (r16)**. Every non-Egbuka piece is r8+, so a 4-man elite-ceiling stack is genuinely cheap. **W17 is LAR@TB (env 77.8)** — the best bring-back game in the set: **Puka Nacua (r1), Davante Adams (r4), Colby Parkinson (r17)**. The fast pace means advance-phase correlation between Mayfield and his top-3 is high week to week, not just in the final.

Draft Takeaway

This is the portfolio centerpiece — concentrate aggressively. Highest ceiling (79.0, 5th), fastest pace, highest-total championship game, and the cheapest elite heavy stack (0.8117). Build: Egbuka round 3 → Godwin/Irving mid → Mayfield + McMillan/Otton late for a 4-wide stack → **Rams bring-back (Nacua/Adams) for the W17 shootout.** The only caution is Mayfield's grade regression (83.6→64.8) — but in this environment, volume and pace carry it. No fade here; this is a max-concentration team.

Tennessee Titans (TEN)

Ceiling Score **56.2** | Rank **18/32** | Tier **MID**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **MID** — **score 56.2, rank 18/32** — but that ranking is driven by *variance* (QB ascend), not a good environment. Full-season identity: a slow-paced (19th), heavily pass-leaning (56.4%, 3rd) offense in the **worst scoring environment in football (env 3, 6.5 wins)**. Draft bottom line: **a cheap-value stack with real bust risk** — pass volume creates targets, but the low total and shaky protection cap the ceiling.

Full-Season Environment

Brian Daboll (new OC) with a 58.2-play, top-3 pass-rate attack — but env 3 means low implied totals and the team projects to trail. Ceiling drivers lean on upside, not floor: **QB ascend 16.0, Pass rate 12.8, Scheme upgrade 12.4, Concentrated tree 8.4** (131% vacated). The bet is entirely on a Cam Ward leap. **Defense (Gus Bradley, new DC): heavy Cover-3 ZONE (~55% C3), low man; PASS-funnel** (soft coverage 14th, worst-in-set), CB1 Cor'Dale Flott "exploitable" — Tennessee's soft pass-D drives opponents to throw, which is why the W17 vs PIT game env (55.2) is playable despite Tennessee's own low total.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

The **soft slate is the one tailwind** — the pass-catchers carry a "78th-pctl favorable defenses" flag, aiding the advance phase. **Week 1 vs NYJ** is a recurring best-week (Ward, Spears, Ayomanor peak; note NYJ is your own team). Wan'Dale peaks W4 BAL. Playoffs: **W15 IND, W16 LV, W17 vs PIT (game env 55.2, opp ceiling 54.2)** — a mid-total, winnable championship spot against Pittsburgh (again, your own team — a reciprocal game). W16 LV is soft. Slow-start-risk offset by a soft schedule.

Key Fantasy Players

Carnell Tate (WR, ADP 62.7, rank 56, +6 value). The lead and best value: 12.6 proj, 32.4 ceiling, **86th projection, 84th ceiling**, 127 targets, soft-slate (78th) tag. A market-beating WR2 anchor.

Wan'Dale Robinson (WR, ADP 107.8, rank 114). 10.3 proj, 116 targets, zone-lean (2.14 zone, 80th), slot-heavy (73%), 92nd explosive, 82nd separation. Best fits vs zone (W5 HOU, W16 LV). Low weekly floor is the flag.

Calvin Ridley (WR, ADP 191.3) & Gunnar Helm (TE, ADP 181.3, +3). Ridley is an **elite man-beater** (2.92 man, 95th; C1 94th) and boundary vertical — a cheap ceiling WR3 whose W14 DET fit is +0.079. Helm is a coverage-agnostic value TE (64th projection) but 3rd-pctl boom.

Tony Pollard (RB, ADP 71.7) & Tyjae Spears (157.6). Pollard 11.3 proj / 73rd, 247 carries; Spears a 73rd-boom receiving back (50 targets). **Cam Ward (QB, ADP 138.2, late)** is the stack QB — but note his **bottom-tier man-coverage split (6.0 Y/A, 26th)** and 7th-pctl protection: he fades vs man/blitz.

Stacks & Correlation

Best is a **heavy stack: Cam Ward (r12) + Wan'Dale (r9) + Gunnar Helm (r16) + Calvin Ridley (r16)**, stack_score 0.6638 — all pieces r9+, so it's cheap. **W17 is PIT@TEN**, the reciprocal of the Steelers game: bring back **DK Metcalf (r7), Michael Pittman Jr. (r8), Pat Freiermuth (r17)**. Because both TEN and PIT are your teams and they meet in Week 17, you can construct a **single correlated championship game** owning both sides — a portfolio efficiency. Advance-phase correlation is helped by the top-3 pass rate (lots of Ward dropbacks).

Draft Takeaway

Cheap value-stack, eyes open on the floor. Tate (r6) beats his market and Ridley (r16)/Helm (r16) are near-free ceiling; the whole stack costs mid-to-late capital. But env 3 and Ward's man-coverage/protection issues mean this is

a *tournament dart*, not a core concentration. Go-to build: Tate as the WR2 anchor → Wan'Dale mid → Ward + Ridley/Helm late → correlate with the PIT side of the W17 game. Treat it as upside exposure, not a floor play.

Washington Commanders (WAS)

Ceiling Score **24.9** | Rank **28/32** | Tier **LOW**

Verdict

Ceiling tier **LOW** — score **24.9**, rank **28/32**. Full-season identity: a balanced, average-pace offense in a **low-total environment (env 16, 8.5 wins)** whose ceiling rests almost entirely on Jayden Daniels' dual-threat upside. Draft bottom line: **fade the team-level ceiling; own Daniels and McLaurin as individuals** and correlate cheaply.

Full-Season Environment

David Blough (new OC), 58.7 plays, balanced (52.1% pass), env only 16 — few shootouts. Ceiling drivers are modest: **Win total 12.6, Shootout script 7.4, Pass rate 7.2, Pace 6.7**; the single fade flag is "weak own pass-D → shootout volume," which is actually the *positive* driver here. **Defense: soft coverage (7th pctl), soft run D (1st pctl — worst in the league) — no listed funnel; CB1 unlisted.** This is a genuinely bad defense that will trail and get thrown/run on, which *should* generate shootout scripts — the main path to a Commanders ceiling week is a track meet forced by their own defense.

Schedule Arc — Full Season

Advance phase is a **gauntlet** — nearly every Commander carries a "30th–33rd-toughest defenses" flag (Daniels matchup pctl 30, McLaurin 35). Best individual weeks: **Daniels W2 DAL, McLaurin W5 NYG, JCM W5 NYG**. Playoffs: **W15 ATL, W16 MIN, W17 vs JAX (game env 37.6, opp ceiling 50.3)** — a low-total championship game; **W16 MIN is a scheme-soft bonanza** for the pass-catchers (Okonkwo +0.185, Luke McCaffrey +0.13 fits vs Minnesota's two-high). Tough-slate throughout with a low-total finish.

Key Fantasy Players

Jayden Daniels (QB, ADP 69.3, rank 63, +6 value). The engine: **19.4 proj, 35.6 ceiling, 92nd projection, 89th coachspeak, and 131 carries** — the rushing floor is the entire ceiling case in a low-total offense. Best week W2 DAL; playoff up-weeks strong (W15 1.0, W16 0.9, W17 0.9). Low weekly floor flag, but the QB1-overall-upside rushing profile is real.

Terry McLaurin (WR, ADP 45.2, rank 51). 13.0 proj, 32.4 ceiling, 88th projection, 77th boom, 119 targets. **Zone-destroyer** (2.73 zone, 94th; zone bucket 96th, C3 97th, C6 93rd) and a boundary X with 18 end-zone looks. **W16 MIN (+0.026) and W13 TEN (+0.055) are strong**; man/shadow is his kryptonite (0.83 vs man, 14th).

Rachaad White (RB, ADP 112.3) & Jacory Croskey-Merritt (ADP 123.2). A split backfield: White the receiving back (47 targets, 67th projection, two-high beater); JCM the early-down runner (196 carries, 77th explosive). Own the pass-catching White for best-ball.

Chig Okonkwo (TE, ADP 141.3, +6) & Antonio Williams (WR, ADP 166.6). Okonkwo is a value TE (61st projection, 88th separation/YAC) whose **W16 MIN fit is a set-high +0.185**; Williams a contingent WR3.

Stacks & Correlation

Stacks are **thin** — **stack_score 0.3809** (lowest with WAS), only 3 pieces on board: **Daniels (r6, not late) + Terry McLaurin (r4)** skinny, or + **Chig Okonkwo (r12)**. The correlation ceiling is capped by the low env. **W17 is JAX@WAS (env 37.6)** — bring back **Brian Thomas Jr. (r6), Parker Washington (r6), Jakobi Meyers (r10)** off Jacksonville (opp ceiling 50.3 > WAS's own 24.9), so the *bring-back* is arguably better than the stack. Across the season, Daniels' rushing makes the Daniels–McLaurin correlation looser than a pure passing stack (his points don't all flow through the WR).

Draft Takeaway

Fade the team ceiling; roster the two studs. Daniels (r6, +6 value) and McLaurin (r4) are strong individual values you'd draft regardless, but the 24.9 team ceiling, low env, and 0.3809 stack score say **don't concentrate**. If you own them, the natural Week-17 correlation is a **Jacksonville bring-back** (BTJ/Meyers), whose offense out-ceilings Washington's. Go-to build: Daniels and/or McLaurin as standalone values, a cheap Okonkwo dart for the W16 MIN spot, and ceiling/stack equity sourced from TB/SF/PHI instead.

Portfolio note across this set: TB (ELITE, 79.0) and the twin HIGH teams SF/PHI (66.8) are the concentration/game-stack targets — and the W17 slate hands you two reciprocal championship games among your own teams (PIT@TEN and, via bring-backs, PHI@SF). NYJ (22.8) and WAS (24.9) are individual-value mines, not stacks; SEA (JSN) and PIT (cheap 4-wide) are the best value stacks; TEN is a low-floor tournament dart.